



IDMP TEST SERIES - 2022

High Yielding PRELIMS TEST SERIES

Test - 12

Ancient History

Topics covered:

- Stone Age, Indus Valley Civilization- Bronze
- Early Vedic Age (1500-900 BCE), Later Vedic Age (900 -600 BCE)
- Mahajan padas / Age of Buddha, Jainism and Buddhism
- Mauryan Empire, Post Mauryan Age, Megaliths and Sangam Age
- Gupta Age, Post Guptas
- Current Affairs June 2021



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DEDICATED PRELIM PROGRAM(DPP)**UPSC-CSE PRELIMINARY TEST SERIES – 2021/2022****DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO**

TEST BOOKLET SERIES

Test Code:**DPP****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST -12****E12****Time Allowed: Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

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2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE A, B, C OR D AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.

3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the provided alongside this line. DO NOT write anything else on the Test Booklet.

4. This Test Booklet contains 100 questions. Each question is printed in English. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose ONLY ONE response for each item.

5. All items carry equal marks.

6. Penalty for wrong answers:

THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.

- I. There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, One-Third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
- II. If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
- III. If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.

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TOPICS COVERD: Stone Age, Indus Valley Civilization- Bronze Ag, Early Vedic Age (1500-900 BCE) Later Vedic Age (900 -600 BCE), Mahajanapadas / Age of buddha, Jainism and Buddhism, Mauryan Empire , Post Mauryan Age, Megaliths and Sangam Age, Gupta Age, Post Guptas. Current Affairs June 2021



Q.1) In the context of the Harappan Civilization, consider the following statements:

1. The inhabitants of this civilization were well equipped with the potter's wheel and the stone art.
2. It was a secular civilization devoid of idol worship.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.2) Consider the following pairs:

Harappan site	Feature
1. Allahdino	Jewellery
2. Kot Bala	Salt production
3. Balu	Garlic

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.3) Consider the following statements regarding the Indus Valley Civilization:

1. There is no concrete evidence for the use of silver in this civilization.
2. Presence of metallic money encouraged large scale trade.
3. The knowledge of burnt bricks was obtained from the Egyptian civilization.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.4) Consider the following statements regarding the Harappan civilization:

1. They were located on semi-arid lands and required irrigation.
2. Dholavira was equipped with a system of water reservoirs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.5) With reference to the ancient history of India, the word Shamans refer to:

- a) A priest who performed the last rites of the dead.
- b) Men and women with healing and magical powers.
- c) Traders during the time of the Indus valley civilization.
- d) The wandering ascetic who renounced all worldly existence.

Q.6) In the context of the Harappan Civilization, which of the statements given below is/are incorrect?

1. Importance to private life was evident in the manner of construction of the houses.
2. The Great Bath was housed in the lower town and was used for ritual bathing.
3. Precious belongings of a person were usually buried with him/her.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.7) Consider the following pairs:

Artefact	Material
1. Pashupati Seal	Quartz
2. Dancing Girl	Copper
3. Bearded priest	Steatite
4. Male torso	Bronze

Which of the pairs given above is/are incorrectly matched?

- a) 2, 3, and 4
- b) 1, 2, and 4
- c) 1, 3, and 4
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.8) Consider the following statements regarding trade during the Indus Valley Civilization:

1. Copper was obtained from Magan, another name for Oman.
2. Harappans used boats and ships to facilitate trade.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.9) Which of the statements given below is least appropriate regarding the Indus Valley Civilization?

- a) The Late Harappan civilization showed evidence of rural life.
- b) End of a unifying state, Harappan, may have marked the end of this civilization.



- c) Deforestation and change of river course attributed to the local decline in certain settlements.
d) Large amounts of polychrome pottery were used by the people.

Q.10) In the context of religious beliefs during the Harappan civilization, consider the following statements:

1. Worship of phallus and female sex organs was prevalent.
2. The use of amulets for warding off spirits is mentioned in the Atharva Veda.
3. The seals found in the Harappan civilization are devoid of images of trees.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 2 only

Q.11) With reference to Harappan Civilisation, Consider the following pairs:

Harappan Site	Findings
1. Dholavira	-- one of the longest Indus inscription.
2. Mohenjo daro	-- Bearded priest
3. Lothal	-- Bead making factory
4. Harappa	-- Pashupati Seal

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- d) All of the above

Q.12) With reference to Indus Valley Civilization, which one of the following statements is not correct?

- a) Unlike some of the Other Harappan cities, which were divided into two parts, Dholavira was divided into three parts.
- b) In Daimabad, which is the southernmost IVC site, a sculpture of a bronze Chariot has been found.
- c) Harappa and Mohenjo-daro had fire altars where sacrifices may have been performed.
- d) In Mohenjo Daro a very special tank, which archaeologists call the great bath, great granary a bronze dancing girl has been found.

Q.13) Consider the following statements about the Chalcolithic culture and Indus Valley Civilisation:

1. Both of them venerated the mother goddess.

2. There is an absence of belief in the afterlife in the Chalcolithic period but this belief had gradually developed in the Indus Valley Civilisation people.
3. Both of them depict the presence of social inequalities.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.14) With reference to cities of Harappan civilization, consider the following pairs:

Element of Harappan Civilisation Found from the city

1. Artificial dockyard	Lothal
2. Signboard	Dholavira
3. Ploughed field	Kalibangan
4. 12 granaries	Mohenjodaro

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- d) 2, 3 and 4 only

Q.15) Consider the following statements about Rig Vedic society:

1. The Rig Vedic society was predominantly a tribal society.
2. Land did not form a well established type of private property among the people in the society.
3. Women slaves were presented as gifts to the priests
4. Aryans were actively hostile towards the 'Dasas' who were the indigenous inhabitants.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1, 2 and 4
- b) 1, 2 and 3
- c) 2 and 3
- d) 4 only

Q.16) In the context of Vedic period, match the following pairs :

Ancient River Name Present Day River Name

(1) Suvasthu	-	(A) Swat
(2) Kubha	-	(B) Kabul
(3) Gomati	-	(C) Gomai
(4) Asikini	-	(D) Jhelum
(5) Sadanira	-	(E) Gandak
(6) Vitastata	-	(F) Chenab

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:



- a) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D, 5-E, 6-F
- b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D, 5-E, 6-F
- c) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-F, 5-E, 6-D
- d) 1-A, 2-B, 3-E, 4-F, 5-C, 6-D

Q.17) With reference to the Early Vedic period, consider the following statements:

- 1. The early Vedic society was male dominated.
- 2. Agriculture was their primary occupation.
- 3. They domesticated the horse.
- 4. They used spoked wheels in their chariots.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- b) 1, 2 and 3
- c) 2, 3 and 4
- d) 1, 3 and 4

Q.18) With reference to the status of women in the vedic period, which of the following statements are correct?

- 1. Womens composed hymns and rose to the rank of seers during the early vedic period.
- 2. Girls had freedom in the selection of husbands and the purdah system was absent during the early phase.
- 3. Remarriage of widows was permitted during the rig vedic period.
- 4. Status of women declined drastically in the later Vedic period.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- b) 2 and 3
- c) 2, 3 and 4
- d) 3 and 4

Q.19) The other name of Aryans as observed in the Vedic period is -

- a) Manusi praja
- b) Maruts
- c) Pasubandha
- d) Godhuma

Q.20) With reference to the difference between the Rig Vedic and Later Vedic period, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1. Only voluntary offerings were taken in the Rig Vedic Period whereas the system for Collection of taxes was established in the Later Vedic Period.

- 2. In the Early Vedic Period, the barter system was more prevalent whereas it was largely replaced by the exchange of gold and silver coins in the later vedic period.
- 3. The Kings in Rig vedic time did not possess any standing army but its presence was heavily seen in later vedic time for territorial expansion.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.21) With reference to the Economy during Early Vedic period, consider the following statements:

- 1. There was no concept of private property based on land ownership during the Rig Vedic period.
- 2. The Rig Vedic people were aware about basic operations of sowing crops but unaware about concepts of soil fertility.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.22) Consider the following statements regarding 6th Century India:

- 1. Ajatshatru was responsible for ending the long-standing rivalry between Magadha and Avanti.
- 2. Smelting of iron ore was extensively done in the cities of the Avanti kingdom.
- 3. Vaishali emerged as the capital of Magadha under the rule of Nandas.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.23) Consider the following cities:

- 1. Ujjain
- 2. Shravasti
- 3. Pataliputra
- 4. Vaishali
- 5. Rajgir

Which of the above cities never served as the capital of the Magadha till the Mauryan times?

- a) 1, 2, and 4 only
- b) 1 and 2 only



- c) 4 and 5 only
d) 1, 2, and 3 only

Q.24) In the context of the Magadha Empire, consider the following statements:

1. The strategic importance of Rajgir declined with the emergence of cannons..
2. The inhabitants of the Magadha were mainly orthodox Hindus of the upper varnas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.25) Consider the following pairs:

Feature	Introduced by
1. Kharosthi script	- Greeks
2. Preamble of Ashokan edicts	- Iran
3. Extensive use of Elephants in army	- Nanda
4. Horse chariots	- Vedic people

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1, 2, and 4 only
d) 2, 3, and 4 only

Q.26) In the context of the 6th century India, consider the following statements:

1. Anguttar Nikaya, a Buddhist text, mentions the Mahajanapadas.
2. The rise of Mahajanapadas coincided with the disappearance of the Pali texts.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.27) In the context of the ancient history of India, the term *Sulvasutras* refer to:

- a) texts containing extensive records of the Suluva and Tuluva dynasty.
b) texts dealing with the methods of measurements and geometry.
c) texts containing the records of lands with their ownership.
d) texts dealing with the rules of astronomy and the position of stars.

Q.28) Consider the following statements regarding the age of the Buddha:

1. The decline in the circulation of coins as compared to the Vedic times.
2. Emergence of a large number of nucleated settlements.
3. Emergence of intermediaries for the purpose of tax collection.
4. Extensive use of paddy transplantation for the purpose of rice production.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
b) 2 and 4 only
c) 2, 3, and 4 only
d) 4 only

Q.29) Consider the following statements regarding the political system of 6th century B. C.E.:

1. Frequent removal and election of the kings by the people was prevalent.
2. Ministers were the kinsmen of the kings and hence mostly Kshatriyas.
3. Payment to Brahmins was done with the grant of land revenue and administrative powers.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only
d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.30) Consider the following pairs:

Officers	Charge
1. Shaulkika	Toll taxes
2. Bhandagarika	treasurer
3. Tirthas	religious pilgrims
4. Gaulmika	stable and cow-sheds

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
b) 1 and 2 only
c) 2 and 4 only
d) 3 and 4 only

Q.31) In the context of the social structures during the times of Buddha, which of the statements is/are incorrect?

1. Beginning of the upanayana ritual among the Shudras.
2. Discrimination in the laws as per the stature of the varna.



Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.32) Which of the following statements is least appropriate with respect to *Chaityas*?

- a) A sacred place amidst nature with a shrine for worship.
- b) A funeral mound extended from the Chita or a funeral pyre.
- c) A sacred place for debates and discussions on life.
- d) Places associated with the life of Buddha.

Q.33) In the context of history of India, Consider the following statements:

- 1) Mahayana Buddhism preaches Universal liberation and self-nirvana.
- 2) Belief in the Savior exists both among the Theravadins and Vaishnavism.

Which of the statements given above is/ are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.34) Which of the following are the components of *Triratnas* (three jewels) of Buddhism?

- a) Sutta, Vinaya, Abhidhamma
- b) Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha
- c) Darshana, Gyana, Charitra
- d) Dipankar, Gautam, Maitreya

Q.35) In contexts of the various sects under Buddhism, consider the following statements:

- 1) Pali was the dominant language of Mahayana Buddhism.
- 2) Sthaviravada is a sub sect under Hinayana Buddhism.
- 3) Lotus Sutra is an important text associated with Theravada Buddhism.
- 4) Kosala and Magadha are the only two kingdoms visited by Gautam Buddha.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 2 and 4 only

Q.36) Consider the following statements regarding Buddhism:

- 1) Abhidhamma pitaka was compiled in the Buddhist Council patronized by King Ashoka.
- 2) It was under the patronage of King Kanishka that the Mahayana and Hinayana sect cropped up.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.37) In reference to Buddhism, consider the following statements:

- 1) Padmapani is regarded as the bodhisattva of power.
- 2) Bodhisattvas are both male and female.
- 3) Vajrayana Buddhism believes in the Tantric practices.
- 4) Buddha was a contemporary of Bimbisara and Ashoka.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 4 only

Q.38) Consider the following statements regarding Buddhism:

- 1) Buddhism believed in impermanence and the path of moderation.
- 2) It believes that societal relations are of divine origin and must be preserved.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.39) With reference to the history of India, the term *Shalabhanjika* denotes -

- a) Woman depicted in sanchi stupa that signifies the enrichment of Buddhism with other cultural beliefs.
- b) Woman depicted in the Sanchi stupa that signifies strength and wisdom to attain nibbana.
- c) Woman depicted in the Sanchi stupa that signifies the spiritual experiences of a woman.
- d) Mahapajapati Gautami, first women to become a part of the Sangha order.



Q.40) With reference to the history of India, the term *Kutagarashala* refers to -

- a) place where prisoners were kept.
- b) place where debates and discussions took place.
- c) place for the storage of grains for the military.
- d) place for the research on herbs and medicines.

Q.41) With reference to the cultural history of India, consider the following:

- 1. Non-injury to a living being
- 2. Do not steal
- 3. Do not speak a lie
- 4. Abstain from intoxication
- 5. Observe Chastity
- 6. Abstention from corrupt practices.

Which of the above mentioned great vows are not related to Jainism?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 4 and 6 only
- c) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only
- d) 1 and 2 only

Q.42) Consider the following statements:

- 1. The second Jain Council was convened at Pataliputra
- 2. The final compilation of Jain literature was called Angas.
- 3. Only men were admitted to Jain sanghas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of above

Q.43) With reference to Jainism, Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1) Vardhamana Mahavira is regarded as the founder of Jainism.
- 2) Anekantavada is the core doctrine of Jainism.
- 3) The concept of Brahmacharya was propounded by Mahavira.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below ?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 2, and 3
- d) 2 only

Q.44) Consider the following statements regarding Jainism:

1) Digambara school of Jainism practices complete nudity and prohibits women from being a part of this sect.

2) Brahmacharya is rigidly practiced under the Svetambara school of Jainism.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.45) Consider the following statements:

1) Ajivikas believe in niyati or that the fate of every matter in the universe is predetermined.

2) The concept of Sunyata was propounded by Nagarjuna under Mahayana Buddhism.

3) Bhadrabahu was an exponent of the Digambara sect of Jainism.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.46) In the context of religious-cultural history of India, consider the following:

- 1) Agriculture
- 2) Starvation
- 3) Vedic authority
- 4) Madhyam Marg (middle path)
- 5) Existence of soul
- 6) Absolutism

Which of the above practices/beliefs were considered unacceptable by Bhagwan Mahavira ?

- a) 1, 2, 3, and 5
- b) 2, 3, 4, and 5
- c) 1, 3, 4, and 6
- d) 2, 3, 5, and 6

Q.47) With reference to the religious sects in India, consider the following statements regarding the differences between Jainism and Buddhism:

- 1. Women are strictly prohibited to be a monk in Jainism, while they could be so in Buddhism since its inception.
- 2. Like Tirthankars who guide individuals to right knowledge, Buddhism too does not believe in self-liberation.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only



- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.48) Consider the following statements with reference to Buddhism and Jainism:

1. Both Buddhism and Jainism do not acknowledge the existence of God.
2. The bifurcation of Buddhism into Hinayana and Mahayana happened before the bifurcation of Jainism into Digambara and Svetambara.
3. Buddhism condemned the Varna system, while Jainism did not.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.49) Consider the following statements about the Jainism and Buddhism:

1. Mahavira was a contemporary of Buddha.
2. In Jainism, 'Nirvana' refers to the end of suffering and freedom from the cycle of life and birth, whereas in Buddhism it means attainment of 'enlightenment'.
3. Both Buddhism and Jainism had influence over Mathura School of arts.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.50) Consider the following statements:

1. There was an enormous gap between the wages paid to the highest and lowest ranking Govt. officials in the Mauryan empire.
2. *Pativedaka* and *Pulisani* were officers who were appointed by the king to oversee appointments to the lower administrative posts.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.51) Which of the following phrases defines "Ardhasitikas" and "Svaviryopajivins" generally referred to in the sources of the Mauryan period?

- a) High officers responsible for security of frontier forts

- b) Sharecroppers who worked on state owned lands
- c) Personnel in charge of weights and measures
- d) Officers responsible for suppression of criminals

Q.52) With reference to the period of the Indo-Greeks in the post Mauryan Period, which of the following statements is *not* correct?

- a) One of the Indo-Greek rulers is the central character in Nagasena's Buddhist text *Milindapanha*
- b) The Indo-Greeks continued to the Mauryan practice of issuing Gold coins for state use
- c) The Greek Rule is memorable on account of the introduction of Hellenistic art features in North-West India
- d) The Besnagar Pillar Inscription showcases that Indo-Greeks rulers were tolerant to and even adopted Hinduism

Q.53) How did the Shaka-Kushana Phase and the contacts with Central Asia impact the then Indian culture and polity?

1. Introduced the Satrap system of Government
2. Responsible for the advent of Mahayana Buddhism
3. Contributed heavily to development of Medicine and Chemistry
4. Patronized and contributed to development of Sanskrit Literature in India

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 and 4 only
- c) 1, 2 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.54) Consider the following statements about the sangam literature:

1. *Tolkappiyam* is a treatise on grammar and poetics.
2. *Tolkappiyam* is the only book surviving from the first sangam.
3. *Silappadikaram* written by Sittalai Sattanar provides valuable information on the Sangam polity and society.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) None of the above



Q.55) With reference to Sangam period/age in the history of India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Hereditary monarchy was the form of government in the Sangam age
2. The only source of revenue was the tax on foreign goods.
3. Absence of practice of Sati was a remarkable feature of this era.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.56) With reference to the sangam era, consider the following pairs:

1. Kurinji - Agricultural lands of the sangam age.
2. Nadu Kal - Chief deity was Murugan
3. Ettutogai - Eight Anthologies of the sangam era.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.57) Consider the following pairs:

Sangam Literature	Matter/subject of the book
1. Silappadikaram	– It is about the love affair of Kovalan, Kanagga and Madhavi.
2. Tirrukural	– Describes the socio-economic condition of the Pandya country.
3. Maduraikkanji	- Deals with philosophy and wise maxims .

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 3 only

Q.58) Consider the following statements with respect to the Sangam Era:

1. Commodities from the Tamil Kingdoms were in high demand in foreign markets.
2. Vanigars were agriculturists whereas the vellalas carried on trade and commerce.
3. Valangai and Idangai were types of traders in the Chola rule.

Which of the statements given above are/is correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.59) Consider the following pairs:

Land Type in Sangam Society	Chief Occupation
1. Marudam	- Agriculture
2. Palai	- Robbery
3. Mullai	- Hunting

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched ?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.60) With reference to the Sangam Age, which of the following phrases best describes the terms *Arasar* and *Anthanar* ?

- a) Famous chieftains belonging to the sangam age
- b) Literary works that portray the Social life during the Sangam Age
- c) Names of primary deities of the Sangam period
- d) Various castes with specific occupations

Q.61) With reference to Sangam Age, consider the following statements:

1. The period was known for its liberal values with women allowed to choose their life partners.
2. One of the high points of the period was the complete absence of practice of Sati.
3. Karpu or Chaste life was considered the highest virtue of women.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect ?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.62) Consider the following commodities:

1. Cotton Fabrics
2. Spices
3. Ivory Products
4. Horses
5. Sweet Wine
6. Precious stones

Which of the above commodities constituted the main exports of the Sangam Age and contributed to the flourishing trade between south Indian kingdoms and Greek Kingdom ?



- a) 1,2,4 and 5 only
- b) 1,2,3 and 6 only
- c) 4,5 and 6 only
- d) 1,2,3,4,5 and 6

Q.63) The sculptures of Yaksha and Yakshi are an important part of Mauryan Art, consider the following statements about Yaksha and Yakshini:

Earliest mention of Yaksha and Yakshi is found in Samveda.

All of the Jain Tirthankars were associated with a Yakshi.

With the exception of Buddhism, they are worshipped within both Jains and Hindus.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect ?

- 1 and 3 only
- 2 and 3 only
- 3 only
- 1 only

Q.64) Assertion (A): The great cities of the Mauryan times were mainly built of wood instead of stone.

Reason (R): Wood was used because it was much easier to carve than stone and the Mauryan craftsmen were not skilled in stone work.

- a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- b) Both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
- c) A is true but R is false
- d) A is false but R is true

Q.65) Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding Allahabad Pillar inscription ?

- 1) It is related only to Samudragupta.
- 2) It is written by Harisena in Sanskrit language.
- 3) It proves that the character of Samudragupta was like that of Ashoka.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) None of the Above

Q.66) With reference to the history of India, Consider the following pairs:

Text	Author
1) <i>Brihat Samhita</i>	- Varahamihira
2) <i>Ashtanga Samgraha</i>	- Banabhatta
3) <i>Kavyadarsa</i>	- Dandin

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.67) Consider the following statements regarding the Gupta Empire:

- 1) The practice of primogeniture was fully developed.
- 2) The demarcation of civil and criminal law was done.
- 3) The recruitment to various posts was done from the lower varnas as well.
- 4) Gupta had a well organized bureaucracy compared to Mauryas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 4 only
- d) 2 and 4 only

Q.68) With reference to the ancient history of India, consider the following statements:

- 1) The system of granting tax free lands to the priests was started by the Guptas.
- 2) The feudal polity greatly reduced the need for appointing officers during the Gupta times.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.69) In the context of the Gupta times, consider the following statements:

- 1) Extensive use of copper coins by the citizens.
- 2) Emergence of Brahmin landlords.
- 3) Improvement in the Economic status of Shudras.
- 4) Freedom of livelihood to women of higher varnas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 4 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only



Q.70) In the context of Gupta dynasty, Consider the following pairs:

- 1) Mehrauli Iron Pillar inscription - Chandragupta II
- 2) Navratna - Samudragupta
- 3) Checked Hun Invasion - Skandagupta
- 4) Bhitari monolith inscription - Kumaragupta

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 and 4 only

Q.71) Which of the following provisions is incorrect with respect to PradhanMantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana ?

- a) Its objective is correcting regional imbalances in the availability of affordable/reliable tertiary healthcare services and also to augment facilities for quality medical education in the country.
- b) Setting up of a new AIIMS (All India Institute of Medical Sciences) is one of its components.
- c) The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare is the nodal agency to implement the scheme.
- d) None of the Above.

Q.72) The "One Stop Centre Scheme" related to ?

- a) One stop Vaccination centres at semi urban and rural areas for vaccination of all age groups and will cater to different types of Covid-19 vaccines and doses .
- b) Providing assistance to Indian women who are survivors of gender-based violence.
- c) Ease of doing business by providing all the license and various authorization related works for starting a business under a single roof.
- d) A single platform where all the information relating to Government services can be accessed and applied as per eligibility norms.

Q.73) Consider the following:

- 1. Principles of Natural Justice
- 2. Powers of a Civil court
- 3. 44th Constitutional Amendment Act
- 4. Chandra Kumar Case, 1997
- 5. Maximum age of chairman and members is 62 years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct regarding the Tribunals under Part XIV-A of the Constitution?

- a) 1, 2, 4, and 5 only

- b) 1, 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 2, 3, 4, and 5 only
- d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Q.74) Consider the following pairs:

Infrastructure initiatives

Associated Countries

- 1. Build Back Better World - G-7
- 2. Global Infrastructure Facility - G-20
- 3. Blue Dot Network - USA, Japan, Australia
- 4. Asia-Africa Growth Corridor - India-Japan

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1, 2, and 3 only
- b) 1, 2, and 4 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, and 4

Q.75) Consider the following statements regarding the Israel-Palestine issue:

- 1. The two state solution was agreed upon at the Madrid Conference of 1991.
- 2. Dehyphenation policy of India calls for combined talks with the two in case of any project in Jerusalem.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.76) In the context of the Social Stock Exchanges, which of the statements given below is/are correct?

- 1. It allows both for profit and not for profit organizations to raise funds.
- 2. India is the first Asian country to come up with this initiative.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.77) In the context of Radioisotope Thermoelectric Generators, which of the statements given below is/are correct?

- 1. It is a nuclear based technology that deals with the generation of power in space.
- 2. It makes use of the thermocouples and generally it does not involve moving parts.



3. It generates energy due to the natural decay of Plutonium 238.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.78) Consider the following statements regarding the Neglected Tropical Diseases (NTDs):

1. Virus, Bacteria, and Helminths are the only causative agents for these diseases.
2. The END7 initiative seeks to end seven Neglected Tropical Diseases by 2022.
3. These are rare diseases found in less than a million of the population in the tropical and subtropical regions.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.79) Consider the following pairs:

Tribes	State/UT
1. Hakki Pikki	- Andhra Pradesh
2. Dard	- Ladakh
3. Angami	- Nagaland
4. Onge	- Assam

Which of the following given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 4 only

Q.80) Consider the following statements regarding Alternative Infrastructure Funds (AIF):

1. Alternative Investment Fund prohibits foreign investors from investing in them.
2. SWAMIH, a kind of AIF-II, is registered under the Securities and Exchange Board of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.81) Which of the statements is *least* appropriate regarding the Radio Frequency Identification Technology?

- a) FASTag and E-way bills are integrated with the RFID technology.
- b) It is developed and operated by the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI).
- c) Electronic Product Code (EPC) is a 13-digit code encoded on the FASTag for identification.
- d) Higher security and automatic data logging are its important security features.

Q.82) Consider the following statements regarding the temples situated at Kanchipuram:

1. Kanchipuram is situated on the banks of river Vegavathi.
2. The temples are dedicated to Lord Shiva and Lord Vishnu.
3. Both the Vijayanagar and the Pallava rulers constructed temples on this site.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.83) In India, inclusion of a specific industry in the "Harmonised Master List of Infrastructure sub-sectors" gives the industry access to cheaper funding including foreign currency funding.

In this regard, Which of the following ministries accords the infrastructure status to industries in India?

- a) Ministry of Road transport and highways
- b) Ministry of Home Affairs
- c) Ministry of Finance Affairs
- d) Ministry of Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises

Q.84) Which of the following sites have recently been added to the list of UNESCO World Heritage sites ?

1. Satpura Tiger Reserve
2. Ganga Ghats of Varanasi
3. Hirebenakal Megalithic Site in Karnataka

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) None of the above



Q.85) Consider the following statements:

1. The "Race To Zero" is a comprehensive energy roadmap released by the International Energy Agency.
2. The "Net Zero by 2050" is a global campaign to rally leadership and support from businesses for a zero carbon recovery that unlocks inclusive and sustainable growth.

Which of the above statements is/are incorrect ?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.86) Which of the following statements with reference to 'New Big 5 Project' is correct?

- a) It is a collaboration between top 5 vaccine manufacturers of the world to increase the production of COVID-19 vaccine.
- b) It is a project to reduce marine plastic in 5 hotspots around the world.
- c) It is a project to protect 5 biggest mountains of the world from human encroachment.
- d) It is a wildlife photography aims to **raise awareness** about the crisis facing the world's wildlife

Q.87) The initiative 'Christchurch Call to Action', recently seen in news, is related to:

- a) Ending the issue of hunger and malnutrition because of COVID-19 pandemic
- b) Providing funding to developing countries to avoid debt-trap diplomacy
- c) Ending online terrorist and violent content
- d) None of the above

Q.88) Consider the following pairs of places in news and their location:

Places in News	Country
1. Helmand	— Afghanistan
2. Vorukh	— Armenia
3. Cali	— Colombia

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.89) Consider the following statements with reference to Putola Nach:

1. It is a form of shadow puppetry from Assam.
2. The themes include the episodes of Ramayana and Mahabharata along with chants taken from Bhaona.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.90) Consider the following statements about Currency Swap Facility:

1. It is a transaction in which two countries exchange an equivalent amount of money but in different currencies.
2. It can be used to borrow foreign exchange at lower interest rates.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.91) Consider the following statements about Blackbuck:

1. The Velavadar Sanctuary of Gujarat is related to the protected areas of Blackbuck.
2. The Bishnoi community considers Blackbuck sacred and worships them.
3. In India, Blackbuck is found only in the Deccan Plateau.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.92) With reference to the State Disaster Response Fund, consider the following statements:

1. Cyclone, Drought, Hailstorm, Landslide, Pest attack and Cold wave are the disasters covered under the State Disaster Response Fund.
2. The Centre contributes 75% of the SDRF allocation for all the states and Union Territories.
3. It is audited by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India every year.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.



Q.93) In the context of Indian and Oman relations, consider the following statements:

1. Both India and Oman are members of Indian Ocean Rim Association and the Gulf Cooperation Council.
2. Al Nagah is an army exercise conducted between India and Oman.
3. Access to Duqm Port by India is a strengthening factor in India Oman relations.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.94) In the context of the Space Programmes, consider the following statements:

1. Mars Orbiter Mission is the first interplanetary space mission of Indian Space Research Organisation.
2. China's Tianwen-1 became the first spacecraft to land on Mars.
3. OSIRIS-REx is NASA's first mission to visit a near-Earth asteroid.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.95) In the context of Organic farming in India, consider the following statements:

1. Taking 2019 as the base year, India tops both in terms of area and the total number of producers involved in organic farming.
2. For a farm subjected to chemical inputs, a transition period of a minimum one decade is to be undertaken to be certified as an organic farm.
3. Owing to the growth of modern agriculture, there are presently no large contiguous areas of organic farming in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.96) In the context of the AISHE (All India Survey of Higher Education Report), consider the following statements:

1. The stand-alone institutions that are not empowered to provide degrees, are excluded from its purview
2. In its report for 2019-2020, the gender disparity was observed in the favor of females.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.97) Consider the following:

1. Article 39 of the Constitution
2. ILO Convention 182 and 138
3. Gurupadaswamy Committee
4. 86th Constitutional Amendment Act

Which of the above directly or indirectly deals with provisions against Child Labor?

- a) 1, 2, and 3 only
- b) 2, 3, and 4 only
- c) 1 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, and 4

Q.98) In the context of Genome Editing, Consider the following statements:

1. Chimeric Antigen Receptor T cells provide a cost efficient way for the treatment of cancer.
2. The accuracy of the CRISPR-9 is enhanced due to the absence of the RNA guide.
3. TALENS, ZFNs are the techniques in the cutting of the DNA.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.99) Consider the following pairs:

Personality

Association

1. Ram Prasad Bismil : Mainpuri Conspiracy 1918
2. Bakim Chandra Chattopadhyay : Bangadarshan
3. Jyotiba Phule : Bhavan Kashi
4. Surendra Nath Bannerjee : A Nation in Making

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1, 2, and 4 only
- b) 1, 2, and 3 only
- c) 2, 3, and 4 only



d) 2 and 4 only

Q.100) In the context of Genome Editing, Consider the following statements?

1. Chimeric Antigen Receptor T cells are found to be effective in neutralizing the cancer cells.
2. The accuracy of the CRISPR-9 is enhanced due to the absence of the RNA guide.
3. TALENS, ZFNs are the techniques in the cutting of the DNA.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3



Q.1) Ans: D

Source: Poonam dalal pg 55, nitin Singhania pg 1.4

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Harappan civilization or the Indus Valley Civilization can be classified into three phases: Early Harappan Phase (3200-2600 B.C.); Mature Harappan Phase (2600-1900 B.C.); and Late Harappan Phase (1900-1300 B.C.). There exists slight variation in each of the phases, yet it is marked by continuity in each of the phases. The Harappan civilization was known for its extensive **town planning** and **well designed drainage pattern**. Besides, there was a huge degree of **craft specialization**. The Harappan people were well equipped with potter's wheel and made red pottery with black designs. However, they were poor in stone art.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Harappan civilization was marked by the absence of the temples and favored the worship of trees, animals, and followed idol worship. There were no temples, and it was largely a **secular** civilization. Yet, a number of terracotta figurines of the female goddess, the Pashupati seal, and the phallus worship indicate that idol worship was practiced.

Source: Poonam dalal, pg: 55, 60, 61

Q.2) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Harappans greatly specialized in the making of **beads** and made jewellery of gold, silver, carnelian, and other precious stones. At a site named **Allahdino**, near **Karachi**, a lot of jewellery made up of gold, silver, copper, carnelian, and other precious stones have been unearthed.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Kot Bala** is a Harappan site located in **Pakistan** from where the earliest evidence for the use of **furnaces** have been found. **Kerala-no-dhoro** in **Gujarat** is another Harappan site from where evidence of **salt production** has been obtained.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Balu** is a Harappan site located in the state of **Haryana** from where the evidence for the production of **Garlic** has been found. It is also famous for the various plant remains obtained from this site.

Q.3) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Harappan civilization is known to have shown earliest evidence of **silver**. The Harappans greatly specialized in the making of **beads** and made jewellery of gold, silver, carnelian, and other precious stones.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The trade during the Harappan times was largely based on the **barter system** as there was no metallic money in use. The trade was both internal as well as external. **Inland transportation** was also used to facilitate trade. They had trade relations with the inhabitants of the contemporary **Mesopotamian** and the **Persian** civilizations and were usually referred to as *Meluhha* by them. They mainly exported the **agricultural items** and the **finished products** like cotton goods, pottery, beads, ivory products, etc.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** A large-scale use of **burnt bricks** was used in the buildings by the Harappan people. However, their knowledge for the use of burnt bricks was not obtained from the Egyptian civilization as the buildings there were mainly made of dried bricks.

Source: Poonam dalal; pg 55, 57. Old ncert : pg 56

Q.4) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The people of the Harappan civilization practiced **agriculture** as evidence of grains have been recovered which includes wheat, barley, lentil, rice, millets, etc. However, they were mostly located on semi-arid lands and therefore required extensive irrigation for agriculture. The evidence of a canal found from **Shortughai** (trading post) in Afghanistan also indicates that irrigation might have been done through this water.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Dholavira** in **Gujarat** also contains evidence of a **water reservoir** which was used for the storage of water for the purpose of irrigation needs. It is the latest Harappan city discovered and provides evidence of a stadium.



dams, embankments, and a large sized advertisement board.

Source: new ncert pg 3-4

Q.5) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement B is correct:** The word **Shaman** is used to indicate those men and women that have healing and magical powers. They are known to establish communication with the other worlds. It is regarded as a religious practice that is associated with the tribal people. It is different from the *Shramana* tradition which deals with the practices of **Jainism and Buddhism**. The *Shramana* tradition was patronized by the **Ashoka**. It was initiated by the wandering ascetics who renounced worldly existence for the search of the meaning of life and the universe.

Source: new ncert page 24

Q.6) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Harappan civilization** is known for its **town planning** and the **well developed drainage** system. The entire settlement was divided into two parts: **The citadel** (which was small in size and was located on a raised platform) and **the Lower town** which was larger in size and was located at a lower level. The city was constructed in a grid pattern and every house had its own bathroom and a drain and was properly lined with bricks. There was absence of windows in the houses at the ground level which indicates that they gave importance to the private life of the person.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The structures that were used for special occasions were mainly found in the citadel. The **Great Bath** is one such structure located in the **Citadel**. It was a structure of public importance and was used for ritual bathing. It was rectangular in shape surrounded by the corridors on the three sides and had rooms for changing as well.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Harappans practiced **pit burials**. In Lothal, burial pits were lined up with burnt bricks while in Harappa, the use of a wooden coffin has been found. Some graves had

pottery and other ornaments that were believed to be used by the dead in the afterlife. However, it is believed that Harappans did not believe in burying precious things with the dead.

Source: New ncert pg 7, 8, 9

Q.7) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** It is obtained from **Mohenjo-daro** and is made of **steatite**. It depicts a human figure of a deity referred to as **Pashupati** with three horned headgear and surrounded by animals like elephants, tiger, rhinoceros, and buffalo. Two antelopes also appear at the bottom of the figure.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** It is found in **Mohenjo-daro** and is regarded as the world's oldest bronze sculpture that depicts a naked girl covered with ornaments and standing in a **tribhanga** position.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Bearded priest** is another figure obtained from **Mohenjo-daro** and made of **Steatite** and is draped in a shawl.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** **Male torso** is obtained from **Harappa** and is made up of **red sandstone**. It depicts only the frontal posture with holes in places of head and arms.

Source: nitin Singhania pg: 1.7, 1.8

Q.8) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Mesopotamian** texts refer to **Oman** as **Magan**. There has been evidence of trade between the Oman and the Harappan people. The trade was of barter type wherein the Harappans exchanged a Jar coated with the thick clay for preventing the percolation of the stored liquid with that of the Omani copper. Presence of Nickel traces in both the Harappan and Omani objects indicates trade relations between the two.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Inland transportation** was highly developed for the purpose of trade. **Mesopotamian** texts refer to the people of the Harappan civilization as **Meluhha** or the land of seafarers. Also, boats and ships are indicated in some of the Harappan seals.



Source: new ncert: pg 13, 14

Q.9) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In the sites that were occupied with the Harappan people post 1900 B.C., there was a stark change observed in the civilization. It showed decline in craft specialization, long distance trade, weights, seals, etc. Also, the building construction declined and were not to the level of times indicating the start of the rural way of life.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The decline of a large unifying state like that of Harappa might have been responsible for the decline of the Harappan Civilization.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** It is believed that factors like deforestation, climate change, shifting of river course may have caused the decline of a regional or a local settlement. However, it is unlikely to have caused the end of the entire civilization.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The Harappans are said to have used **plain or painted pottery.** The painted pottery were referred to as **Red and Black pottery** which were painted with red and had black designs mostly of geometrical patterns, animals and birds. However, the use of polychrome pottery is very rare in Harappan civilization.

Source: new ncert: pg 17, nitin Singhania pg 1.8

Q.10) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Terracotta figures of several female goddesses have been found from the Harappan seals which indicate the worship of **Mother Goddess.** Also, a plant emerging from an embryo indicates that **Mother Earth** was also worshipped. There has been evidence of **Phallus** worship which later developed into Hinduism as **Shivlinga.** Hence, a number of symbols of Phallus and female sex organs have been found which are made of stone.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The people of Harappan civilization wore **amulets** to ward off any evil spirit. The Bronze statue of the Dancing girl from

Mohenjo-daro also carries an amulet in her arms. The use of amulets for warding off spirits also finds mention in the Atharva Veda. Atharva Veda is one of the four Vedas that deals with the cure of several diseases. It also contains the details of several rituals.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Animals like one horned rhinoceros and the humped bull are also worshipped by the Harappan people. They believed in **nature worship.** Trees are also depicted in the seals. In one of the seals, a deity is depicted amidst the branches of a **Pipal tree.**

Source: r s sharma pg 62-63.

Q.11) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** At Dholavira a signboard containing ten letters of the Indus script was found. The inscription is the one of the longest in the Indus script. However until the Indus script is deciphered, what the sign is saying still remains a mystery.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** The figure of a bearded man or the Priest king was found at Mohenjo Daro. Fillet with circular inlay ornament on the forehead & smaller ornament on the Right upper arm.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** **Lothal & Chanhudaro** were famous Bead making factory sites in IVC. Many seals were found in a storehouse found in Lothal.
- **Pair 4 is incorrect:** The famous Pashupati seal is a steatite seal discovered at Mohenjo daro depicts a deity sitting cross legged. The figure wears a 3 horned headgear & is surrounded by animals Elephant, tiger, rhinoceros, buffalo & 2 antelopes.

Q.12) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Unlike Harappa and Mohenjo-daro, Dholavira was constructed to a pre-existing geometrical plan consisting of three divisions – the citadel, the middle town, and the lower town. The acropolis and the middle town had been furnished with their own defence-work, gateways, built-up areas, street system, wells, and large open spaces. The acropolis is the most thoroughly fortified and complex area in the city, of which it appropriates the major portion of the southwestern zone



- **Statement 1 is correct:** The most interesting discovery from Daimabad is a hoard of 4 bronze objects : A sculpture of a chariot yoked by 2 oxen, driven by a man;
A sculpture of a water buffalo;
A sculpture of an elephant;
A sculpture of a rhinoceros.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Lothal and Kalibangan had fire altars where sacrifices may have been performed. At Kalibangan, evidence of ploughed field, wooden furrow, seven fire altars, bones of camels and two types of burials have been found.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** At Mohenjo Daro the great bath, great granary, bronze dancing girl, bearded man, terracotta toys, Bull seal Pashupati seal, Mesopotamian type of seal and a piece of woven cloth have been found.

Q.13) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Terracotta figures of women from the Chalcolithic period suggest that the Chalcolithic people venerated the mother goddess. Similar terracotta figures of the mother goddess have also been found from the Indus Valley Civilisation.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The people of the Chalcolithic period used to deposit pots and some copper objects in the graves for the use of the dead in the next world. This shows their belief in the afterlife. Similarly, Harappan people also buried pottery and ornaments, indicating a belief that these could be used in the afterlife.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Both the settlement pattern and burial practices suggest the beginning of social inequalities in the chalcolithic society. Some settlements in Jorwe are as large as twenty hectares but others are only five hectares and even less. This suggests that the large settlements dominated the smaller ones. In the Indus Valley Civilisation, the citadel and the lower town were depiction of social inequalities.

Reference:

NCERT Class 12, RS Sharma

Q.14) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** At Lothal, a brick structure has been identified as a **dockyard** meant for berthing

ships and handling cargo. This suggests that Lothal was an **important port and trading centre** of the Harappan people.

- **Pair 2 is correct:** One of the most exciting discoveries at Dholavira is a **large wooden "signboard"** just **outside the north entrance to the citadel**. This is actually one of the **longest Indus inscriptions** known. There are **10 symbols** in the panel, each one is about 37 centimetres high and the board on which the letters were inscribed appears to have been about 3 meters long. However until the Indus script is deciphered, what the sign is saying still remains a mystery.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** The **furrows discovered** in the pre-Harappan phase at **Kalibangan** indicate that the fields were **ploughed in Rajasthan during the Harappan period**. The Harappans probably used the wooden plough drawn by **oxen**, and **camels** may also have been used for this purpose.
- **Pair 4 is incorrect:** The findings from **Harappa** include **2 rows of six granaries** with **big platforms**, **stone symbols** of lingam and yoni, **mother goddess sculpture**, wheat and barley in wooden mortar, dice, copper scale and mirror. Moreover, a sculpture of a **dog chasing a deer** in bronze metal, and a **red sandstone male torso** have been excavated. The findings from **Mohenjodaro** include a **great bath**, the **great granary**, **post cremation burial**, sculpture of a **bearded priest**, the famous **bronze statue of the Dancing Girl** and **Pashupati Seal**.

Reference:

NIOS (p. no 34)

RS Sharma (p. no . 59)

Nitin Singhania

<https://www.harappa.com/blog/dholavira-and-its-mysterious-sign-board#:~:text=This%20fabulous%20system%20made%20it,the%20longest%20Indus%20inscriptions%20known.>

Q.15) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** - Administrative machinery of the Aryans in the Rig vedic period worked with the tribal chief in the centre. The chief was known as **rajan** and he did not exercise unlimited power and had to reckon with the tribal organizations.



- **Statement 2 is correct** - Tribal elements in the society were stronger and social divisions based on collection of taxes and or accumulation of landed property were absent. The society was largely **egalitarian**.
- **Statement 3 is correct**: Gifts made to priests were usually cows and women slaves (for household works) and never of land, even those of cereals are rare. The cow seems to have been the most important form of wealth.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect** - The Aryans were engaged in two types of conflicts - first they fought with the pre-aryans and secondly, they fought among themselves. 'Dasas' mentioned in Iranian literature (Avesta) were the branch of early Aryans. Rig Veda mentions the defeat of Sambara by a chief called Divodasa (Bharata clan) 'Dasyus' in the Rig Veda representing the original inhabitants of the country, and an Aryan chief who overpowered them was called Trayadasyu. Active hostility was with the original inhabitants.

Q.16) Ans: C

Exp:

- Rivers being an important part of the history since ancient times. Civilizations flourished upon the banks of the rivers and its valleys due to the factors that include source of water for drinking/agriculture and for communication/trade related aspects. Here are some of the ancient names of the rivers along with their present names. **Sindhu (Indus) is the most mentioned river in Rig Veda.**
 - Asikni - Chenab
 - Vitastata - Jhelum
 - Purushini - Ravi
 - Shatudi - Satluj
 - Drishdvati - Ghagara
 - Vipasha - Beas

Q.17) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** : Aryan society was male dominated and patriarchal in nature. The birth of daughters was not desired, but once they were born, they were treated with kindness and consideration. Women had a position of honour in the household. Women were given equal opportunities as men for their spiritual and

intellectual development. There were women poets like Apala, Viswavara, Ghosa and Lopamudra during the Rig Vedic period. Women could even attend the popular assemblies. There was no child marriage and the practice of sati was absent.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect** : The earliest life of the Aryans seems to have been mainly pastoral, agriculture being the secondary occupation. They owed their prosperity to cattle wealth. Fought wars to gain supremacy of cattle wealth. They were well acquainted with the sowing and harvesting procedures (evident from the excavated wooden ploughshare), they had knowledge about various seasons also. Agriculture was mostly to produce fodder.
- **Statement 3 is correct** : The horses played the most significant role in their lives. Its swiftness enabled them to make successful ventures to new places. The domesticated horse appears in the 6th millennium B.C in the Black Sea and the Ural mountains area. Archaeological evidence of the horse and cremation appears in Swat Valley, Pakistan
- **Statement 4 is correct** : Rig Veda mentions artisans such as the carpenter, the chariot maker, the weaver, the leather worker, the potter, etc. The spoked wheel first appeared in the Caucasus area in 2300 BC. The earliest Aryan lived in the area which is present day eastern Afghanistan and NWFP.

Q.18) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** - Gargi, Maitreyi and Katyayani composed hymns and had scholarly expertise. Early vedic society was male dominated. Birth of daughters was not desired during the early Rig Vedic period, but once they were born, they were treated with kindness and consideration. Their education was not neglected.
- **Statement 2 is correct** - During the Early vedic period Girls enjoyed a lot more freedom than the later vedic period. They were married long after they had reached puberty and there seems to have been considerable freedom in the selection of husbands. There was no purdah system.
- **Statement 3 is correct** - Remarriage of widows was permitted and Niyoga or Levirate (a dead man's brother or next of kin marrying the widow) was



practiced by some. No instances of child marriage or purdah system. Though monogamy was the rule but polygamy was also permitted. Instances (Maruts marriage with Rodasi) of polyandry were also there.

- **Statement 4 is correct** - Status of women declined in the later Vedic period and there was social stratification based on gender lines. Their participation in ceremonies was restricted. They were stripped of the right to attend assemblies. According to Aitareya Brahmana, a daughter has been described as a source of misery.

Q.19) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Option A is correct:** The Aryans were also known as **manushi praja**, who worshipped Agni and who sometimes set fire to the house of black-skinned people. The Aryans and their enemies can be identified by the colour of their skin.
- **Option B is incorrect:** Almost all the Vedic Gods are associated with horses, and this is particularly true of Indra and his fighting companions, the **maruts**. The horse symbolizes strength and is generally employed as a metaphor for might. The Vedic people prayed for horses in addition to praja and pasu.
- **Option C is incorrect:** Cattle sacrifices of the Vedic period were called **pasubandha**, the cattle rearers offered meat to their Gods and in return asked for cattle wealth, so that their practice of sacrificing cattle and eating meat continued.
- **Option D is incorrect:** Wheat in the Vedic period was known as **godhuma**. Other crops were barley (yava), beans, sesamum(tila) and **vrihi**-rice.

Source:Page A 92:Indian History by Krishna Reddy.Mcgraw Hill

Q.20) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct.** Only voluntary offerings (Bali) were taken in the Rig Vedic Period whereas the system for tax Collection was established in the Later Vedic period. The officers called **sangrihitri** were appointed for that purpose. Vaishyas were the only tribute payers in Later Vedic times.

- **Statement 2 is correct.** : In the later vedic period life became sedentary and the domestication of animals and cultivation increased. The idea of private possession of lands started taking shape. Trade was also boosted. Thus the barter system in the early vedic period was replaced by the exchange of gold and silver in the later vedic period.
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** : The Kings in Rig vedic time **did not possess any standing army**. In the later Vedic Period, Territorial expansion led to certain rivalry among the different groups, a still standing army was not possessed by the king in the Later Vedic period and gramas mustered in times of war.

Source of reference : Ancient Indian History OLD NCERT

UPSC question referred for this: 2017 PRELIM SET A Q.2

Q.21) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct:** The Rig Vedic economy was clan based and pastoral in nature. Evidence of trade and commerce is meagre, and there was no concept of private property based on land ownership. The clan as a whole enjoyed rights over the resources.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** Though agriculture during the Rig Vedic period was primitive, the Rig Vedic people were aware about the concepts of soil fertility. The Rig Vedic hymns refer to the levelling of fields for cultivation, **the desire for fertile fields (urvara), and furrows (sita) drenched by rain, producing rich harvests.**

Source: Ancient and Medieval India, Poonam Dalal, Dahiya

History of Ancient and Early Medieval History
Upinder Singh

Q.22) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Anguttara Nikaya**, a buddhist text, mentions the presence of the 16

Mahajanpadas or the large states. They extended to the North of the Vindhya range from the North-west frontier to Bihar. Of these, **Kosala** and **Magadha** were the two powerful ones. **Magadha** emerged into power during the rule of the **Haryanka Dynasty** and its ruler **Bimbisara**. He was succeeded by his son **Ajatshatru**. The capital of the Magadha then was **Rajgir**. The last ruler of this dynasty, **Udayin**, was succeeded by the **Shishunaga dynasty**. **Avanti** was the biggest rival of Magadha and had capitals at **Ujjain** and **Mahishmati**. This rivalry ended with the defeat of the Avanti by the **Shishungas**. Hence, it was not Ajatshatru rather **Shishungas** that brought an end to Avanti.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The importance of Avanti lies in the presence of good quality iron weapons and the extensive use of smelting and forging to smelt the iron ore.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The **Shishungas**, who succeeded the Haryanka Dynasty by defeating their last ruler **Udayin**, shifted capital to **Vaishali** from **Rajgir**. The **Shishungas** were defeated by the **Nandas** who had enormous strength of the army.

Source: R S sharma pg: 105-106

Q.23) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option B is correct:** The cities of **Ujjain** and **Shravasti** never served as the capital of **Magadha** from its rise to the end of the Mauryan times. **Ujjain** was the capital of the **Avanti** and was known for extensive use of smelting and forging of iron and good quality iron weapons. **Shravasti** served as the capital of the **Kosala** kingdom which extended in the **Gonda** and **Bahraich** districts of **Uttar Pradesh**. **Pataliputra** served as the capital of **Magadha** during the times of the **Mauryas** due to its strategic importance. **Vaishali** served as the capital of the **Magadha** during the rule of the **Shishungas** and **Rajgir** (surrounded by five hills) was the capital during the **Haryanka Dynasty**.

Source: R. S. Sharma: pg 103, 104, 105, 131

Q.24) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Rajgir** was also called as **Girivraja** as it was surrounded by five hills and any opening was closed by the stone walls. Hence, it was entirely enclosed and impregnable and was difficult to invade with the level of military technology present during that time. However, with the use of cannons, the city could be easily invaded and hence, its strategic importance began to decline.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The **Magadha** society was unorthodox in character. It was mainly inhabited by the **Magadhas** and **Kirtas** who were regarded lowly by the orthodox Brahmins. The rulers of **Magadha** were more inclined towards military conquests and hence it emerged as the first large kingdom by defeating the other kingdoms.

Source: R S sharma pg 106

Q.25) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Iranian and Macedonian invasions left an impact on the culture and social history to the regions of the North-west. There were a number of small principalities in the region at continuous war with each other and this disunity was taken as an advantage by the foreign rulers. The **Achaemenian** rulers of Iran under **Darius** and **Xerxes**, conquered areas to the west of Sindh including Punjab and Sindh. The **Kharosthi script** was introduced by the **Iranian invasion**. It is written from right to left and is present in a number of **Ashokan** inscriptions in the north-west.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The monuments of Ashoka at that time were influenced by the Iranian contacts. The presence of preamble on the Ashokan edicts along with the bell shaped Ashokan capital is influenced by the Iranian contact.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** There was an extensive use of elephants in the army as witnessed in the army of the **Nandas**. The **Nandas** were known to have possessed as many as 6000 elephants which made it easy for the crushing of cities and forts.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The horse chariots were introduced by the **vedic people**. However, its



significance began to decline in the later times with the introduction of cavalry, infantry, and elephants. However, their use was not completely stopped.

Source: R S sharma: pg 108, 109, 106, 117

Q.26) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per the Buddhist text, Anguttara Nikaya, there was the existence of **16 Mahajanapadas**. The period of **6th Century B. C.** was regarded as the era of **Second Urbanisation in India**. Among the 16 Mahajanapadas or the large states, **Kosala and Magadha** emerged as the most powerful ones. The idea of territorial importance increased manifold as the people showed greater allegiance to the *Mahajanapadas* they belonged to as against that of the *Jana* or tribe.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The record of this period was obtained from a number of Pali and Sanskrit texts and hence, there was no disappearance of the Pali texts. The Buddhist texts, Sutta, Vinaya, and Abhidhamma pitaka were composed in **Pali** language. The *Jataka* tales are written in both **Pali and Sanskrit** language.

Source: Poonam dalal pg 128, R S sharma 115 and 120

Q.27) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Option B is correct:** It was during this period that *Sulvasutras* were produced and dealt with measurement systems, especially the measurement of fields and houses. *Sulvasutras* deals with the field of geometry and mathematics. They are classified into four with the oldest one ***Baudhayan sulvasutra*** dealing with the Pythagoras theorem or the calculation of the length of the sides of a right angled triangle. They are the reference of the Mathematical knowledge from the vedic people and formed part of the appendices of the Vedas.

Source: Poonam Dahiya 374, R S Sharma pg: 114

Q.28) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The terms like *nishka* and *satamana* cannot be conclusively used for the coins. They might have been used as the prestige items made of metals and not necessarily the coins. The trade during the vedic times was largely barter in nature and it was during the time of Buddha that a large number of **silver and some copper coins** came into circulation. These coins were used for the trade and were punch marked with the images of hills, bulls, trees, etc.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** A large number of **nucleated settlements** was observed during the time of the Buddha in the rural areas. The **Pali literature** talks of the nucleated settlements in which people along with their land and property lived away from the main settlements in the Gangetic plains. The text also talks of the three types of villages namely, the typical kind, the craft villages, and the border villages.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** During this time, the tax collection was done mainly by the royal agents directly and hence there were no intermediaries on a large scale. **One-sixth** of the total produce was collected as taxes from the peasants directly.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** In the **eastern Uttar Pradesh and Bihar**, rice served as the main cereal and was grown on a large scale. A number of paddy fields have been described in the **Pali and Sanskrit** texts. **Wet paddy production or paddy transplantation** emerged on a large scale during this time.

Source: R S sharma pg 115-116.

Q.29) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Kosala and Magadha** emerged as two most powerful kingdoms during the times of Buddha. According to the *Jataka*, people would remove the kings and priests who were oppressive to the people. However, such occasions of removal and election of the kings were very rare. The states were **hereditary monarchies** and the kings belonged to the **kshatriya** varna. They enjoyed the highest stature and protection. They were warlords who won battles and expanded their states.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The kings ruled with the help of the **ministers and officials**. They generally belonged to the **Brahmana varna** and the practice



of appointing Kshatriya kinsmen as ministers and officers as was prevalent in the Vedic times was greatly reduced. There were both high and low officials. The higher ones were called *mahamantras*, *mantrin*, etc.

- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The payment to the Brahmins and officials were done mostly with the help of **silver punch-marked coins**. However, in some cases payment was also done as a grant of revenue for the villages. In these cases, only the revenue was given, and no administrative powers were sanctioned to the beneficiary.

Source: R S sharma: 116-117

Q.30) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** *Shaulkika* or *Shaulkadhyaksha* were the officers responsible for the collection of taxes in the form of customs and tolls. Artisans were also supposed to pay taxes on account of customs or the sale of their commodities. Peasants were supposed to pay one-sixth of their produce as tax.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** *Bhandagarika* were the officers responsible for the control of treasury during the times of Shakyas and Lichchavis. The other officials included the *raja* (king), *uparaja* (vice-king), *Senapati* (Commander), etc.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Mauryas had a very well organized bureaucracy consisting of officials of the higher and lower ranks. Important officials of the Mauryan times were referred to as *Trithas*, which included *mantrin* (minister), *purohit* (high priest), *Senapati* (commander-in-chief), *yuvaraj* (crown prince).
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** *Gaulmikas* were the officials during the times of the *Satavahanas*. He was the head of the military regiment and was in charge of the administration of the rural areas.

Source: R S sharma pg 118, 119, 130, 158

Q.31) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The people during this time were divided into four varnas- *Brahmanas*, *Kshatriyas*, *Vaishyas*, and *Shudras*. The *Dharmasutra* provides a clear mention of the

duties and the civil and criminal laws relating to each varna. The crime against *Brahmin* and *Kshatriyas* was treated with heavy punishment while the punishment for the upper varnas was lighter. The *Shudras* were accorded the lowest status with no legal or religious rights. They were meant to serve the upper varnas. They were denied the *Upanayana* or the holding of the sacred thread.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The laws and rules as compiled in the *Dharmasutra* varied with each *Varna*. Shudra were considered to have emerged from the feet of the creator and hence were accorded the lowest position with no legal or religious rights.

Source: R S Sharma: pg 120

Q.32) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Several interpretations of *Chaitya* have been found. In some, it is considered as a site for those surrounded by nature with a shrine meant for the purpose of worship.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The word *Chaitya* has been derived from the word *Chita* which means the funeral pyre and hence is also regarded as the extension of the funeral mound.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** A place meant for debates and discussion has not been regarded as a *chaitya*.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** In Buddhist literature, *Chaitya* also refers to the sacred places associated with the life of Gautam Buddha, i.e., **Lumbini**, where he was born, **Bodh Gaya**, where he received Enlightenment, **Sarnath**, where he delivered his first Sermon, and **Kushinagar** where he attained Mahaparinirvana.

Source: New Ncert themes I, page: 95-96

Q.33) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** After the **Mahaparinirvana** of Gautam Buddha, Buddhism was divided into **Mahayana** and **Hinayana** at the fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir.



- The **Hinayana** is an orthodox form of Buddhism and believes in the original preaching of Buddha. It does not believe in idol worship. Hinayana Buddhism was preached by King Ashoka. **Mahayana** Buddhism on the other hand, deals with idol worship and believes in the concept of Bodhisattvas (one that imbibes the Buddhist nature).
- **Bodhisattvas** are those that help all human beings to attain liberation and hence a Bodhisattva delays his/her own salvation to enable others to achieve it. Hence, it does not believe in the individual being attaining *nirvana* for his/her own self like the Hinayana Buddhism.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Theravadins** is a subsect under Hinayana Buddhism. It deals with the cessation of suffering and attainment of Nirvana. It does not believe in the existence of a Savior like the Mahayana Buddhism which believes in Bodhisattvas that would liberate all human beings.
- **Vaishnavism** believes in the presence of a Savior. The incarnations of Lord Vishnu were meant to save the world whenever it was in danger. The last avatar, Kalki, to end the demon Kali, is yet to come as per the mythologies.

Source: statement 1 : nitin singhania, page 14.6 and 14.7; Statement 2: new ncert themes I, pg 104.

Q.34) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Sutta, Vinaya, and Abhidhamma pitaka** are the Buddhist texts which were compiled in the various Buddhist councils. **Sutta pitaka** deals with the beliefs and sermons of Buddha. **Vinaya Pitaka** deals with the rules of the Buddhist order while the **Abhidhamma pitaka** deals with philosophical matters. These three are collectively called **Tripitakas**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Buddha, Dhamma, and Sangha** are considered as the three jewels or **triratnas** of Buddhism. **Buddha** refers to as the Enlightened being, **Dhamma** comprises his teachings and doctrines, while **Sangha** denotes the monastic order.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Darshan, Gyan, Charitra** or the Right belief, Right Knowledge, and Right

Conduct are the **triratnas** of Jainism and not Buddhism.

- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** **Dipankar** refers to the predecessor of Buddha, the present Buddha is regarded as **Gautam**, and the future Buddha is **Maitreyi**.

Source: Nitin singhania page 14.2

Q.35) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Mahayana Buddhism** meant the **greater vehicle**. It was a more liberal form of Buddhism as compared to Hinayana which was orthodox in nature. Mahayana Buddhism believed in the concept of **Bodhisattvas** which were compassionate beings who delayed their own salvation to help others in attaining salvation. Hence, they believed in universal salvation of all living beings. This school of Buddhism was followed by **King Kanishka** who is also regarded as its founder. It mainly used Sanskrit as their main language.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Sthaviravada** also referred to as the Theravada is a subsect under **Hinayana Buddhism**. It focuses on the teachings of Buddha as its central theme. **Theravada** refers to the school of older monks. Their ultimate aim is to end suffering and attain Nirvana. Practices like Samatha and Vipassana form an important part of Theravada tradition. Like the Hinayana tradition, they used **Pali** as their main language.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** **Lotus Sutra** is an important text under the **Mahayana Buddhism**. It deals with six perfections or paramitas to be followed by an individual: Dana, Sila, Ksanti, Virya, Dhyana, and Prajñā. **Mahāvamsa** is another important text related to Mahayana Buddhism. It deals with the history of Buddhism in Sri Lanka.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** **Kosala and Magadha** are the only two kingdoms visited by Gautam Buddha while under these two kingdoms he visited several places like Shravasti, Kapilvastu, Bodh Gaya, Vaishali, Rajgriha, Sarnath, Kushinagar, Nalanda, Mathura, Vaishali, Varanasi, Saket, etc.

Source: Nitin Singhania; page: 14.9, 14.6, 14.10

Q.36) Ans: C



Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Third Buddhist Council was held at **Pataliputra** under the patronage of **King Ashoka** and the chairmanship of **Moggaliputta Tissa**. It was in this Buddhist Council that the compilation of **Abhidhamma Pitaka** took place.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The fourth Buddhist council was held in **Kashmir** under the patronage of **King Kanishka** and the chairmanship of **Vasumitra**. The division of Buddhism into **Hinayana** and **Mahayana** took place in this Buddhist council.
 - The **first Buddhist council** was held at **Rajgir** under the patronage of **King Ajatshatru** and the chairmanship of **Mahakasyapa**. Sutta Pitaka and Vinaya Pitaka came up during this council.
 - The **second Buddhist Council** was held at **Vaishali** under the patronage of **King Kalasoka** under the chairmanship of **Sabakami**.

Source: nitin singhania pg: 14.4 and 14.5

Q.37) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Padmapani is one of the protective deities around Buddha in the Ajanta Caves, who is regarded as the **Bodhisattva of Compassion**. He is also known as **Avalokitesvara** and is holding a Lotus flower in his hand. **Vajrapani**, also depicted in the Ajanta caves, is regarded as the **Bodhisattva of Power**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Bodhisattva could be both male and female. Padmapani is regarded as a female by some.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Vajrayana Buddhism has been influenced by Hinduism. It is also based on the **Mahayana** Buddhist philosophy and believes in **Tantra, Mantra, and Yantra** for the attainment of Nirvana.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** Gautam Buddha was a contemporary of Bimbisara and Ajatshatru. He was not a contemporary of Ashoka.

Extra Edge By Only IAS

- In Mahayana, Buddhism Bodhisattva is a person who can reach nirvana but delays

doing so through compassion for suffering beings.

- It is similar to the concept of Incarnations in Hindu Mythology. Bodhisattvas are common figures in Buddhist literature and art

Source: nitin singhania pg 14.8, 14.10 and 14.3

Q.38) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Buddhism believes that the world is transient and soulless and is impermanent. The world is full of sorrows and sufferings caused due to desire. It prescribes the **path of moderation** to attain *nirvana* unlike the Jain philosophy which believes in severe penance.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** According to Buddhism, social relations are the creation of human beings and not divine in origin and hence it is the duty of the human beings to be humane and kind to other human beings. Buddha emphasized that the people must work out their own salvation by way of right actions and burn their ego and desire.

Source: statement 1: nitin singhania: 14.4; statement 2: new ncrt themes I- pg 91, 92

Q.39) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement A is correct:** A number of sculptures are depicted at **Sanchi** which are directly or indirectly related to Buddhism. The sculpture of a woman at the gateway is considered as a sacred symbol and symbolizes the enrichment of Buddhism with the cultural beliefs and the traditions of the non-buddhist people who joined Buddhism. Shalabhanjika is found in different religious sculptures in India, not necessarily Buddhism. It is a symbol of a **Yakshi** (a benign deity associated with fertility), holding a branch of a tree and is depicted in a sensuous form.

Source: ncrt themes I pg, 101

Q.40) Ans: B



Exp:

- **Statement 2 is correct:** *Kutagarashala* was referred to a place where travelling mendicants/beggars halted. It was the place where debates and discussions regarding the truth of life and its various philosophies were taken up. It is associated with **Buddhism** and is regarded as the *Vihara* where the Buddha mostly halted while on his way to Vaishali. It is mentioned in the Pali Buddhist texts as a monastery located in the middle country of ancient India. It was a part of Vaishali.

Source: new ncert themes I, pg 85

Q.41) Ans: B

Exp:

- The three principles of Jainism, also known as Triratnas (three gems), are: 1. Right faith 2. Right knowledge 3. **Right conduct**.
- Right conduct refers to the observance of the **five great vows**:
 1. Not to injure life (Ahimsa)
 2. Not to lie (Satya)
 3. Not to steal (Asteya)
 4. Not to acquire property (Aparigraha)
 5. Observe Chastity (Brahmacharya).
- **Eightfold Path (Ashtang Marg) given in Buddhism**

(1) Right Views	(2)
Right Resolve	
(3) Right Speech	(4)
Right Conduct	
(5) Right Livelihood	(6)
Right Effort	
(7) Right Recollection	(8)
Right Meditation.	

Q.42) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The second great Jain Council was held at **Valabhi** during Gupta period and the Jain Canon of the Svetambaras was written. The first Jain Council was convened at **Pataliputra** by Sthulabahu, the leader of the

Digambaras, in the beginning of the 3rd century B.C.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The final compilation of Jain literature called Twelve **Angas (limbs)** was completed in the second Jain council.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Women were admitted into the monastic order. However, as a woman one cannot attain salvation. But by accumulating merit by good deeds, a woman could be reborn as a man and then strive to attain salvation.

Source of reference : Tamilnadu State Board, Old NCERT by RS Sharma

Q.43) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Vardhana Mahavira is not regarded as the founder of Jainism. He was **24th and the last Tirthankara** of Jainism. The first tirthankara **Rishabhadev** was born in Ayodhya and is regarded as the one who laid the foundation of the ordered and organised society.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Anekantavada** or the multiple dimensions of a truth is a core doctrine of Jainism. According to this, a particular reality has multiple dimensions and there is no absolute definition that can describe the ultimate truth.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The philosophy of Jainism deals with five constraints of life which includes: **Ahimsa** (nonviolence); **Satya** (truthfulness); **Asteya** (not to steal); **Aparigraha** (not to acquire property); and **Brahmacharya** (celibacy). **Brahmacharya** was propounded by Mahavira. It was **Parshvanatha**, the 23rd Tirthankara who propounded the first four constraints.

Source: nitin singhania: pg 14.13, 14,14

Q.44) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Jainism was divided under two main sects: **Digambaras** and **Svetambaras**. **Digambara** school was propounded by **Bhadrabahu** who moved to Karnataka with his discipline predicting a long famine in Magadha. Under the Digambara school of Jainism, the monks practice complete nudity unlike Svetambara who wear white clothes. Women monks are allowed in the Digambara sect and wear plain unstitched white sarees. Women

are not allowed to be Tirthankaras in the case of Digambara.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Svetambaras were those who stayed back in the North. Sthulabhadra was the exponent of this school. They follow the teachings of Pashvanatha who gave the first four constraints: Ahimsa (nonviolence); Satya (truthfulness); Asteya (not to steal); Aparigraha (not to acquire property); while they do not follow Brahmacharya. They wear simple white clothes and believe that even women could be a Tirthankara. They believe that the 19th Tirthankara, Mallinatha, was a female.

Source: nitin singhania pg: 14.15

Q.45) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Ajivika sect was founded by Makkhali Gosala, who was the follower of Mahavira and later left him and founded his own creed. Ajivikas deals with Niyati or fate and believes that destiny is responsible for controlling every matter in the universe.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The concept of Sunyata was given by Nagarjuna under the Mahayana Buddhism. According to this, all the phenomena and matter in existence are devoid of nature, essence, and substance.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Jainism got divided into sects namely: Digambara and Svetambara. The Digambara sect was propounded by Bhadrabahu while the Svetambara was propounded by Sthulabhadra.

Source: new ncert themes I pg, 87; nitin singhania for statement 2 (14.7) and 3 (14.15)

Q.46) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement C is correct:** Jainism believed that all objects whether living or non-living possess souls and must not be harmed. It believes in starvation, renunciation of the world, and strict asceticism. Hence, it rejects the practice of agriculture as it involves killing of insects and other similar beings. Jainism hence believes in Starvation, Vedic authority, Existence of soul, soul is the fundamental unit of Jain philosophy. Buddhism on

the other hand focuses on the middle path and Jainism focuses on the extremities. Jainism does not believe in absolutism. According to Jains, there are many dimensions of the ultimate truth or reality and hence it focuses on **Anekantavada**.

Source: tamil nadu part 1, pg 39; nitin singhania 14.3

Q.47) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** In Jainism women are permitted to be a monk in both Digambara and Svetambara school. However, the Digambaras do not permit women to be a Tirthankar whereas it is permitted in Svetambara. Buddha initially had not permitted women to be a part of the Sangha. However, only with the persuasion of his disciple Ananda that women were allowed to be part of the Sangha. Mahapajapati Gotami, Buddha's foster mother, was the first woman to join the Sangha as a bhikkhuni.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** A tirthankara is a one who has attained Kevalya gyan and guides people to the right knowledge. Buddha himself advocated that each individual must work out his own salvation to free oneself from the cycle of birth and death. It was the main doctrine of Hinayana Buddhism. However, Mahayana Buddhism believes in the concept of Bodhisattva, a compassionate being, who delays his own salvation to help the fellow beings to reach salvation.

Source: statement 1 ncert themes 1 pg: 92 and nitin singhania pg: 14.15; Statement 2: ncert themes I pg 88

Q.48) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Buddhism does not acknowledge a supreme God or deity. Followers instead focus on achieving enlightenment. The path to enlightenment is attained by utilizing morality, meditation and wisdom. Jainism recognised the existence of god but not as a creator and placed them lower than Jina (Mahavira)
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Division of Buddhism into Hinayana and Mahayana happened in the



fourth Buddhist Council (72AD) in reign of Kanishka, whereas the division of Jainism into Digambara and Shvetambara happened 200 years after the death of Mahavira (467 BCE at Pavapuri near Patna) when there was a famine in Magadh. Many Jainas migrated to the South under the leadership of Bhadrabahu, though the rest of them stayed back in Magadha under the leadership of Stahlbau. When the southerners returned, differences emerged between both factions. In order to sort out these differences and to compile the principal teachings of Jainism, a council was convened in Pataliputra, but the southerners boycotted it and refused to accept its decisions. From now onwards, the southerners began to be called digambaras and the Magadhans svetambaras.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Jainism did not condemn Varna, as Buddhism did, but attempted to mitigate the evils of the varna order and the ritualistic Vedic religion. According to Mahavira a person is born in a high or lower class as a consequence of the sins or virtues acquired by him in the previous birth. Mahavira looks for human values even in a chandala. In his opinion, by leading a pure and meritorious life, members of the lower castes can achieve liberation.

Reference:

RS Sharma (page no. 93)

<https://www.history.com/topics/religion/buddhism>

Q.49) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Both Buddha (563BC-483BC) and Mahavira (540BC-468BC) were contemporary. Other contemporaries of Buddha include Bimbisara, Jivaka, Ajatashatru, Vasakara, Amrapali, Prasanjit, Vatsaraja Udayan, Pukkusati, Chandrapradyot, Vasavadutta.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In Jainism, 'Nirvana' refers to the end of suffering and freedom from the cycle of life and birth. Enlightenment in Jainism is known as 'Kaivalya'. Whereas in Buddhism 'Nirvana' means attainment of 'enlightenment' or 'salvation'. Death is called 'Parinirvana'.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Mathura school of arts developed under the patronage of Kushana rulers and was influenced by Buddhism, Jainism

and Hinduism. The Mathura School showed a striking use of symbolism in the images. The Hindu Gods were represented using their avayudhas. For example, Shiva is shown through linga and mukhalinga. Buddha is shown to be surrounded by two Bodhisattvas – Padmapani holding a lotus and Vajrapani holding a thunderbolt.

Reference:

OnlyIAS discussion video
(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F-KAbbJILVY&list=PL2jzazaAMNtWq-vMdPolxejZ1Kq79gqN&index=4>)
Nitin Singhania

Q.50) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The highest functionaries such as the minister (Mantrin), high priest (purohita) etc. were paid as much as 48000 panas (silver coins currency). In sharp contrast to them, the lowest officers were given 60 Panas in consolidated pay with some officials getting as low as 20 panas.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Chandragupta Maurya maintained a body of spies who kept watch on events going on throughout the country and regularly reported to the King. Strabo says that these spies were appointed from the most faithful persons. There is also mention of Pativedakas and Pulisani who functioned as special reporters of the king and kept him informed of public opinion.

SOURCE : Poonam Dahiya Dalal

Q.51) Ans: B

Exp:

- A very important aspect of the Mauryan Economy was the Agricultural developments and modernization. The importance of irrigation was fully realised and peasants had to pay more tax on irrigated land known as udaka-bhaga (water rate, and generally levied at one-fifth to one-third of the produce)
- Share-cropping existed on both state-owned and privately owned land. Kautilya refers to different kinds of share-croppers working on the state-owned land such as the Ardhasitikas (kept half of

the produce) and the **Svaviryopajivins** (kept one-fourth or one-fifth of the produce). It should be noted that there is no reference in any text of taking away the land of the farmers in case of non-payment of taxes. Kautilya also mentions certain **emergency taxes (Pranaya) or additional levies that the state could impose if the treasury got depleted.**

SOURCE : Poonam Dahiya Dalal

Q.52) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:**
 - **Menander** /Milinda/Minedra was one of the most celebrated Indo-Greek rulers who not only stabilised Indo-Greek power, but also extended his empire's frontiers in India.
 - He was **converted to Buddhism by Nagasena** and has been identified with the King Milinda mentioned in the famous Buddhist text **Milindapanha (Question of Milinda)**, which contains philosophical questions that Milinda asked Nagasena (the Buddhist author of the text). The text claims that impressed by the answers, the king accepted Buddhism as his religion.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:**
 - The Indo-Greeks were the first rulers in India to issue coins (gold, silver, copper, and nickel) which can **be definitely attributed to any dynasty and were also the first to issue gold coins in India** (which increased in number under the Kushanas).
 - Interestingly, the **coins of the Shakas, Parthians and the Kshatrapas followed the basic features of Indo-Greek coinage, including the bilingual and bi-script legends.**
 - Indo- Greek coins were miniatures of aesthetic excellence, of precise economic value and also provided useful information on emerging religious sects and cults (specially Shaiva and Bhagvata sects) that were prominent in that area.
- **Statements 3 and 4 are correct:**
 - They introduced new **features of Hellenistic art and literature such as Gandhara art** in the **north-west frontier of India**, which was not **purely Greek**, but rather it was the outcome of

the **intermingling and influence of both Indian, central Asian and Hellenistic contacts.**

- A **striking instance of this mingling is the Besnagar Pillar inscription of Heliodorus - a Greek Ambassador who adopted Vaishnavism.** New terms which had the influence of Greek terminology began to be used in the subcontinent. For instance, the term '**horshastra**' used for astrology in Sanskrit is derived from Greek word 'horoscope'.

Q.53) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:**
 - The Central Asian conquerors introduced new styles in administration. For instance, the Indo-Greeks introduced the practice of military governorship wherein they appointed military governors called strategos while the **Kushanas introduced the 'Satrap' system of government**, under which the empire was divided into numerous satrapis and each satrapi was placed under the rule of a satrap.
- **Option 2 is correct:**
 - The origin of Mahayana Buddhism owes a lot to the **Central Asian influence**. The Central Asian Rulers **did not appreciate the philosophical doctrines of Buddhism and wanted something novel that could satisfy their religious cravings.** The monks and nuns could not afford to lose the cash donations from the growing body of Central Asian traders and artisans and thus now started **accepting gold and silver, took to non-vegetarian food and wore elaborate robes.** Kanishka was the biggest proponent of **Mahayana Buddhism.**
- **Option 3 is incorrect:**
 - Even though Indian Astronomy and Astrology profited from contact with the Greeks, however, **the Indians did not owe anything striking to the Greeks in medicine, Botany and Chemistry.** These three subjects were dealt with by **Charakha and Susruta.**
- **Option 4 is correct:**
 - The **Central Asian rulers also patronised and helped in the growth of Sanskrit literature.** The earliest specimen of **kavya style** and that too in chaste Sanskrit is found in the **Junagadh Inscription of Rudradaman I.** From now onwards, **inscriptions began to be composed**



in chaste Sanskrit although the use of Prakrit continued for a couple of centuries.

SOURCE : Ancient History by RS SHARMA

Q.54) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** - Tolkappiyam is a work on Tamil grammar and it also provides information about the society, political and economic condition of the sangam age. It is a treatise on grammar and poetics.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** - Tolkappiyam is the only book surviving from the second sangam. Works from the first sangam didn't survive. It is believed that it was written by a single author named Tholkappiyar, a disciple of Vedic sage Agastya.
- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** - Silappadikaram written by Ilango Adigal is about love affair of Kovalan, Kanagga and Madhavi. It also provides valuable information on the Sangam polity and society. The Silappadikaram gives a detailed picture about the Tamil culture, its varied religions, its town plans and city types, the commingling of Greek, Arab, and Tamil peoples, and the arts of dance and music.
- Manimekhalai was Written by Sittalai Sathanar continues the story of Silappadikaram in next generation in which Manimekhalai is the daughter of Madhavi and Kovalan.

Q.55) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct** - Hereditary monarchy was the form of government in the Sangam age. The king was assisted by a wide body of officials who were categorised into five councils. They were ministers (amaichar), priests (anthanar), envoys (thuthar), military commanders (senapathi), and spies (orarr).
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** - Land revenue, customs duty on foreign trade and booty captured in wars were the main sources of the income. One sixth of the total produce was collected as land tax. Tolls were also collected. The local chieftains paid tributes and gifts to the king and this income constituted a significant part of the government revenue.

- **Statement 3 is Incorrect** - Sati was still prevalent in the society and practised especially by higher caste women. Widows position in the society was vulnerable. Women were not permitted to remarry and inherit property. Women's education was also insisted during the Sangam Age. There were few women poets like Avvaiyar, Kakkai Padiniyar and Nachchellaiyar, whose verses are found in the Sangam literature.

Q.56) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Incorrect** - Kurinji was the hilly, forested terrain/ tracts of land/ mountainous regions in the sangam age and its chief deity was Murugan whose chief occupation was hunting and honey collection. The other types of land are as follows-
 - Mullai was referred to the pastoral lands and the chief Deity was Mayon,
 - Marudam was the agricultural lands and the chief deity was Indira,
 - Neydal was referred to as the coastal lands and the chief deity was Varunan
 - Palai was the desert lands and the chief deity was Korraivai.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect** - Nadu Kal/ Hero Stone was erected in memory of the bravery shown by the warrior in battle. They were erected to honour valiant men killed in battle, or those who lost their lives while defending their villages or womenfolk. The nadu kals' or hero stones with inscriptions were planted as part of the burial and this has been described by many Sangam poets too.
- **Statement 3 is correct** - The Sangam literature provides valuable information regarding the Sangam Age. The literature includes Tolkappiyam, Ettutogai, Pattuppattu, Pathinenkilkanakku, and two epics named – Silappadikaram and Manimegalai. Among them, The Ettutogai means the Eight Anthologies of the sangam era. They are Aingurunooru, Narrinai, Aganaooru, Purananooru, Kuruntogai, Kalittogai, Paripadal and Padirrupattu.

Q.57) Ans: B

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is correct** - Silappadikaram – written by Ilango Adigal. It is about the love affair of Kovalan, Kanagga and Madhavi. Later, a Kannagi Cult developed in South India
- **Statement 2 is incorrect** - Tirukkural deals with philosophy and wise maxims & was written by Tiruvallur. Tirukkural comprises 133 sections of 10 couplets each is divided into three books: Aram (virtue), Porul (government and society), and Kamam (love).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect** - Madurai Kanji describes the socio-economic condition of the Pandya country and is written by Mangudi Maruthanar.

- Kurinji – chief deity was Murugan – chief occupation, hunting and honey collection.
- **Mullai** – chief deity Mayon (Vishnu) – chief occupation, cattle-rearing and dealing with dairy products.
- **Marudam** – chief deity Indira – chief occupation, **agriculture**.
- Neydal – chief deity Varunan – chief occupation fishing and salt manufacturing.
- **Palai** – chief deity Korraivai – chief occupation **robbery**.

SOURCE : Tamil Nadu Ancient History book Std XI

Q.58) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct** - According to the Sangam literature, the Tamil land had certain commodities which were in great demand in foreign markets. Black pepper, cardamom, ginger, cardamom, cinnamon, turmeric, ivory products, pearls, precious stones. pearls and gemstones, etc. The main imports included horses, gold and glass.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect** - Tolkappiyam refers to four castes namely arasar, anthanar, vanigar and vellalar. The ruling class was called arasar. Anthanars played a significant role in the Sangam polity and religion. Vanigars carried on trade and commerce. The vellalas were agriculturists.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect** - Caste system was widely prevalent during the Chola period. The inscriptions of the later period of the Chola rule mention about two major divisions among the castes – Valangai and Idangai castes. However, there was cooperation among various castes and subcastes in social and religious life.

Q.60) Ans: D

Exp:

- Tolkappiyam refers to four castes namely **arasar, anthanar, vanigar and vellalar**. The ruling class was called **arasar**. Anthanars played a significant role in the Sangam **polity and religion**. **Vanigars** carried on **trade and commerce**. The **vellalas** were **agriculturists**.
- Other **tribal** groups like **Parathavar, Panar, Eyinar, Kadambar, Maravar and Pulaiyar** were also found in the Sangam society. Ancient **primitive tribes** like **Thodas, Irulas, Nagas and Vedars** lived in this **period**.
- The **primary deity of the Sangam period was Seyon or Murugan**, who is hailed as Tamil God. The worship of Murugan had an ancient origin and the festivals **relating to God Murugan** was mentioned in the **Sangam literature**. He was honoured with six abodes known as **Arupadai Veedu**.

SOURCE : Tamil Nadu Ancient History book Std XI

Q.59) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Options 1 and 2 are correct:**
 - **Sangam Epic Tolkappiyam** refers to the five-fold division of lands - Kurinji (hilly tracks), Mullai (pastoral), Marudam (agricultural), Neydal (coastal) and Palai (desert). The people living in these five divisions had their respective chief occupations as well as gods for worship.

Q.61) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Only Statement 2 is incorrect:**
 - There is plenty of information in the Sangam literature to trace the position of women during the Sangam age. **Women poets like Avvaiyar, Nachchellaiyar, and Kakkaiyapadiniyar flourished in this period and contributed to Tamil literature.**
 - The courage of women was also appreciated in many poems. **Karpu or Chaste life was**



considered the highest virtue of women. Love marriage was a common practice.

- Women were allowed to choose their life partners. However, the life of widows was miserable. The practice of Sati was also prevalent in the higher strata of society. The class of dancers was patronized by the kings and nobles.

SOURCE : Tamil Nadu ANcient History book Std XI

Q.62) Ans: B

Exp:

- Options 1,2,3 and 6 are correct:
 - External trade was carried between South India and the Greek kingdoms. After the ascendancy of the Roman Empire, the Roman trade assumed importance. The port city of Puhar became an emporium of foreign trade, as big ships entered this port with precious goods. Other ports of commercial activity include Tondi, Musiri, Korkai, Arikamedu and Marakkanam.
 - The author of Periplus provides the most valuable information on foreign trade. Plenty of gold and silver coins issued by the Roman Emperors like Augustus, Tiberius and Nero were found in all parts of Tamil Nadu.
 - They reveal the extent of the trade and the presence of Roman traders in the Tamil country. The main exports of the Sangam age were cotton fabrics, spices like pepper, ginger, cardamom, cinnamon and turmeric, ivory products, pearls and precious stones.
 - Gold, horses and sweet wine were the chief imports.

SOURCE : Tamil Nadu ANcient History book Std XI

Q.63) Ans: A

Exp:

- Statement 1 is Incorrect: Two of the famous sculptures of the Mauryan period are: Yaksha and Yakshi. The earliest reference of Yakshi can be found in Silappadikaram, a Tamil text.
- Statement 2 is Correct: Yaksha worship was very popular before and after the advent of Buddhism and it was assimilated in Buddhism and Jainism. Hence, all of the Jain Tirthankars

were associated with a Yakshi. For instance, Yaksha Dharenendra and the Yakshi Padmavati are often shown near the Jain Tirthankar, Parshvanath.

- Statement 3 is Incorrect: Yaksha and Yakshi were worshipped by ALL three religions: Jainism, Hinduism and Buddhism.

Reference: Art and culture by Nitin Singhania, Chapter 1

Q.64) Ans: C

Exp:

Megasthenes mentions that the palace of Chandragupta Maurya, though very large and luxurious, was built of carved and gilded wood models on wooden originals. However, this was not because of unskilled craftsmen or because Mauryan architecture was primitive. The mastery in stone work is also evident in Mauryan monolithic columns. Thus, the use of wood over stone is mainly attributed to the fact that stone was comparatively scarce in the Gangetic plain and timber was vastly abundant. The adoption of stone in later periods as a building medium was partly due to foreign contacts, but also to the gradual disappearance of timber forests from the more populous and civilized regions of India. Hence, the assertion is correct but the reason is incorrect.

Ref: The Wonder that was India, A L Basham (Page 348)

Q.65) Ans: C

Exp:

- Statement 1 is incorrect: The Allahabad Pillar inscription gives an account of military conquests of Samudragupta. It describes the circumstances of Samudragupta's accession, his military campaigns in north India and the Deccan, his relationship with other contemporary rulers, and his accomplishments as a poet and scholar. This inscription is engraved on an Asokan pillar. Hence, it is related to both Ashoka and Samudragupta.
- Statement 2 is correct: Prayag Prashasti written by Harisena in Sanskrit gives an account of Samudragupta's conquests.



- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Allahabad Pillar inscriptions indicate that Samudragupta was entirely opposite to that of Ashoka. Samudragupta believed in military expeditions and conquests while Ashoka was a peace loving ruler who renounced warfare post the Kalinga war.

Source: R S sharma 181, 182

Q.66) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** *Brihadsamhita* was written by **Varahamihira** in Sanskrit and deals with a multitude of domains ranging from astronomy, astrology, weather, marriage, animals. Other works by Varahamihira are: **Pancha Siddhantika**, **Brihadjataka**. Pancha Siddhantika is an astronomical text which comprises five earlier astronomical treatises - Surya Siddhanta, Romaka Siddhanta, Paulisa Siddhanta, Vasishtha Siddhanta, and Paitamaha Siddhanta.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Vagbhata was A disciple of Charaka and a distinguished physician of Ayurveda. He wrote **Ashtangsamgraha** which is a work on medicine. He also wrote Ashtangahridaya.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** *Kavyadarsha* was written by **Dandin**. He was also the author of **Dasakumaracharita**.

Source: Tamil Nadu part I pg 108, 109

Q.67) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The succession during the Gupta rule was mainly **hereditary**. However, the practice of primogeniture (transfer of throne to the eldest son) was not fully developed and this led to uncertainties and chaos which was misused by the chiefs and other officials. There were numerous gifts made to the **Brahmanas** during the Gupta times who compared the Kings to God.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Guptas had a very well **developed judicial system** where several books on law were compiled. Civil and criminal law was clearly distinguished for the first time during the Gupta rule. The **King was regarded as the ultimate upholder of the law**. Crimes like

adultery, theft, etc were put under criminal laws while those relating to property inheritance were put under the civil laws. However, the guilds of artisans, merchants, traders, etc. were governed by their own set of laws.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Gupta rulers were themselves **Vaishyas** and hence made recruitment from the lower varnas as well. The Kumaramatyas were the important officials during the Gupta rule and were directly appointed by the king and paid in cash. A single person held several posts under the Gupta rule and posts were generally **hereditary** which loosened the control of the King over his officials.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The bureaucracy of Guptas was not as organized as the Mauryas. The civil servants were known as Amatyas during the Mauryan times. Mauryans had a council of ministers called the **Mantriparishad** who helped the king in the administration. It included Purohita, Mahamantri, Senapati, and Yuvraj. Ashoka had appointed **Dhamma Mahamantras** who helped in the enforcement of Dhamma.

Source: R S sharma pg 186-187, Tamil nadu pg 67

Q.68) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The system of granting land tax free to the priests was started in the Deccan by the Satavahanas. This system was fully developed during the Gupta times especially in **Madhya Pradesh**. Priests were given tax free land and were even empowered to collect taxes from the peasants. The priests were also given powers to punish the criminals.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The participation of artisans, merchants, elders, and even priests in the administration greatly reduced the need to appoint administrators during the Gupta times. Hence, the major chunk of the Gupta Empire was administered by the feudal chiefs and the beneficiaries of land grants. The areas in the Northern parts of Bengal, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, and some areas of Madhya Pradesh were administered by the officials appointed by the Gupta rulers whereas other areas near the fringe of the empire were administered by the **feudal vassals**. These feudal vassals received the King's charters for ruling the areas under their control in return for



tribute to the King. Samudragupta greatly exercised control over these feudal vassals.

Source: R S sharma: pg 187-188

Q.69) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Gold coins during the Gupta times were called **Dinars** and were issued in large numbers. They portrayed the conquests of the Gupta rulers. However, they were not as pure as that of the Kushan gold coins. Silver coins during the Gupta times were mainly used for the purpose of local exchange. The copper coins were very few in number and hence indicate that the common citizens did not make much use of money unlike the Kushan period.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Land grants given by the Gupta rulers to the Brahmin priests brought huge expanses of land under cultivation with better knowledge of cultivation imparted by the Brahmanas. They emerged as landlords while the local peasantry was subjugated.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The economic status of Shudras improved during the Gupta times due to their employment in the agricultural activities while in the earlier periods, Shudras were mostly servants and slaves of the higher varnas. They were permitted to listen to the Mahabharata, Ramayana, Puranas, and other religious scriptures. They could even conduct domestic rites that brought income to the priests.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The women of lower varnas were given the freedom to work in the agricultural fields and not depend fully on their husbands. On the other hand, the women of the higher varnas were still deprived of the freedom of livelihood. Men of higher varnas acquired huge land and property. They were mostly polygamous and looked at women as property.

Source: R S sharma: pg 188, 189, 190

Q.70) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Mehrauli Iron Pillar inscriptions talk of the conquests of **Chandragupta II**. It is famous for the rust-resistant

composition of the metals used in its construction.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Chandragupta II patronized the **Navratnas** or the nine gems, the most important among them was *Kalidasa*. Others were: *Amarsimha, Dhanvantri, Harisena, Kahapanaka, Sanku, Varahamihira, Vararuchi, Vetala Bhatta*.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Hun invasion was faced mainly by **Skangupta** who protected the empire from the Huns. However, weak successors of Skandagupta could not save the Gupta empire from the Huns. Ultimately, the Gupta power totally disappeared due to the Hun invasions and later by the rise of Yasodharman in Malwa. Banabhatta in his Harshcharitra refers to the Huns invasion.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** **Bhitari monolithic pillar** inscription deals with **Skandgupta**. It is located in Gazipur, Uttar Pradesh. It provides chronology of the various Gupta rulers. It also mentions the conflict between Skandagupta and the Pushyamitras as well as the Hunas.

Source: R S Sharma 184, tamil Nadu 107, 103, 106

Q.71) Ans: D

Exp:

- Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY), a Central Sector Scheme, was announced in August 2003 to address imbalances in availability of tertiary care hospitals and improve medical education in the country.
- The Scheme two components, namely;
 - Setting up a new AIIMS (All India Institute of Medical Sciences).
 - Upgradation of government medical colleges in various states.

The project cost for upgradation of each medical college institution is shared by the Centre and the state.

So far the setting up of 22 new AIIMS has been approved under the scheme, out of which six AIIMS at Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, Jodhpur, Patna, Raipur and Rishikesh are already fully functional.

- The PMSSY is implemented by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.



Q.72) Ans: B

Exp:

- One Stop Centre Scheme (OSCs) being implemented by the Ministry of Women and Child Development and has provided assistance to over 3 lakh women so far.
- The scheme is being implemented across the country since 1st April, 2015 through State Governments/ Union Territory (UT) Administrations to provide **integrated support and assistance to women affected by violence and in distress**, both in private and public spaces, under one roof and facilitate immediate, emergency and non-emergency access to a range of services including police, medical, legal aid and counseling, psychological support to fight against any forms of violence against women. Till date, 701 OSCs in 35 States/UTs have been operationalised.
- Recently, The Central government announced to set up One Stop Centres (OSCs) across 10 missions to provide assistance to Indian women who are survivors of gender-based violence. The missions where the OSCs will come up are Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, Oman, UAE, Jeddah and Riyadh in Saudi Arabia, Australia, Canada and Singapore.

Q.73) Ans: D

Exp:

Article XIV-A of the **Constitution of India** was added by the **42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976** and provided for the constitution of **Tribunals**. It contains two articles- **Article 323 A** dealing with the administrative tribunal and **Article 323 B** dealing with the tribunals for other matters. **Article 323 A** of the Constitution empowers the Parliament to constitute a tribunal for the adjudication of disputes regarding the service matters and unburden the civil and the high courts. In pursuance of this, the Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 was enacted by the Parliament that empowered the Central government to constitute the Central Administrative Tribunal and the State Administrative Tribunals.

The tribunals have the powers of the civil courts and work on the principle of Natural Justice. It is not bound

by the procedure laid down under the Civil Procedure Code of 1908. The Central Administrative Tribunal is constituted as a multi-member body with a chairman and the members. The retirement age of the chairman is 65 years while that of the members is 62 years. The appointment is done by the Appointment committee of the Cabinet which is selected by the high-powered search committee composed of the judges of the supreme court nominated by the Chief Justice of India. The original Act allowed the appeals from the tribunals to be done to the supreme court only and not to the High Courts. However, the supreme court in the **Chandra Kumar case, 1997** provided that the appeals could be made even to the concerned high court as well and not just to the supreme court.

Q.74) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Build Back Better World** partnership was launched by the **G-7 countries** as a global infrastructure project led by the major democracies to channelize 40 trillion dollars for the developing countries post the COVID pandemic.
- **The Global Infrastructure Facility** is an initiative of the **G-20 countries** to boost private investments in infrastructure projects in developing and emerging countries.
- **Blue Dot network** certifies infrastructure projects in the Indo-Pacific regions and makes them eligible for funding. It channels finance from the financial institutions of the **USA, Japan, and Australia.**
- **The Asia-Africa Economic Corridor** aims to promote **Indo-Japan** collaboration to promote digital infrastructure and connectivity in the African region. It is an economic partnership between the two.

Q.75) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Recent clashes between Israel and Palestine in the Gaza strip were calmed with the mediation led by Egypt. Hamas, a



Palestinian faction controls the Gaza strip and the conflict between the two is on account of the control over Jerusalem, a city considered holy by the Islamic, Judaism, and the Christians. India has always favoured the cause of Palestine. However, in the **Madrid peace conference, 1991** the **two state solution** was agreed upon and India agreed to it. India established full diplomatic relations with Israel in 1992. However, it did not give up its stand on Palestine.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** India came up with the **dehyphenation policy** in the context of relations between **Israel** and **Palestine** in 2018. As per this policy, the relation of India with Israel would be totally independent of Palestine and would have its own merits. It would in no way be influenced by the circumstances and its stance with Palestine.

Q.76) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The idea of **Social Stock Exchanges** was put forth in the Budget 2019 and consequently a working group was constituted by SEBI to recommend the functioning of these stock exchanges. Social stock exchanges are platforms that enable For the Profit and Not for Profit organizations to raise finance for their economic, social, environmental, and other similar projects. Earlier, these organizations would raise finance through the grants by the governments, donations, gifts, Corporate Social Responsibilities, impact investors, etc. However, this would open new channels for their funding.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** India is not the first country in Asia that has come up with this. UK, Canada, South Africa already possess an arrangement of this kind. Besides, Singapore in Asia also has a similar arrangement.

Q.77) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Radioisotope Thermoelectric Generator** or RTGs is a nuclear energy based technology that aims to convert

Thermal energy into Electric energy and is used for the generation of power and management of heat in various space missions. Recently, ISRO's U. R. The Rao Satellite Centre invited proposals for the three phase development of RTGs for its deep space missions.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** An advantage of RTGs is the use of the **Thermocouple**. The generators are governed by the "Seebeck effect" and it generally has no movable parts. Seebeck effect is a phenomenon in which a temperature difference between two dissimilar electrical conductors or semiconductors produces an electromotive force (electricity).
- **Statement 3 is correct:** RTGs make use of the natural decay of **Plutonium-238** for the generation of power. The heat produced by its decomposition is transferred to the thermocouple which is responsible for the generation of electricity.

Q.78) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** **Neglected Tropical Diseases** are caused by the **Viruses** (Dengue, Rabies, etc.), **Bacteria** (Leprosy, Trachoma, Yaws, etc.), **Protozoa** (Chagas, Leishmaniasis, etc.), and **Helminths** (Lymphatic filariasis, River Blindness, Soil transmitted Helminthiasis, etc.).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** END7, an international public awareness campaign to end the seven neglected tropical diseases (NTDs) by 2020. The Seven NTDs are lymphatic filariasis (elephantiasis), river blindness (onchocerciasis), snail fever (schistosomiasis), trachoma, hookworm, whipworm (trichuriasis) and roundworm (ascariasis). The above 7 diseases account for around 90% of the total burden of the NTDs. WHO's strategic roadmap for 2021-2030 also aims to make efforts to end NTDs.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** They are communicable diseases that are found in the tropical and the sub-tropical countries and are found to affect greater than one billion people around the world. Populations suffering from



high incidences of poverty, unhygienic conditions of living, and lack of sanitation are at a greater risk of the miseries caused by these diseases.

Q.79) Ans: B

Exp:

- The **Hakki Pikki** tribe is mainly found in the state of **Karnataka**. They migrated from the northern states and now settled in southern India. It is a nomadic tribe and is known as a bird catcher. They speak the *Vaagri* language which is the Indo-Aryan language categorized as Endangered by UNESCO.
- **Dard Tribes** are the **Buddhist tribes** belonging to **Ladakh** and are mainly found in the districts of Leh and Kargil. These tribes belong to the Aryan culture and the area inhabited by them is referred to as the Aryan Valley.
- **Angami tribes** are the hill tribal groups of the state of **Nagaland** and are also found in some parts of Manipur. They are settled in the hill regions and are known for wet-rice cultivation.
- The **Onge tribe** belonged to the traditional hunter-gatherer community in the **Andamans**. The Great Andamanese, Jarawa, Sentinelese Onge and Shompen are recognized as Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups.

Q.80) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Alternative Investment Funds** are privately pooled investment funds that allow investment from both domestic and foreign investors. It is established in India and categorized into three categories.
 - **Alternative Investment Funds I** are the ones that invest in the startups and the early ventures or the projects that are regarded as socially or economically important by the government.

- **Alternative Investment Funds II** deals with real estate and the funds for distressed assets, etc.
- **Alternative Investment Funds III** deals with different types of funds like hedge funds, etc.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **SWAMIH or the Special Window for Affordable and Mid Income Housing Fund** was created by the government in 2019 to provide priority funding to the stalled housing projects for mid income housing. This is a **SEBI registered fund under the category of AIF II**.

Q.81) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Radio Frequency Identification technology** is a wireless technology that works on the radio waves. It makes use of the electronic tag and an RFID reader that is used for the purpose of identification of the tag. This technology finds its application in the collection of tolls from the vehicles running in the highways.
- A **FASTag** is placed on the vehicle connected with the bank account of the person, and is used for the automatic collection of tolls in the vehicles. The FASTag, when it comes in the vicinity of the RFID reader by making the use of the radio waves, identifies the particular vehicle using the 13 digit Electronic product code unique for each vehicle.
- The **FASTag** is developed by the **National Payment Corporation of India** and is operated by the **National Highway Authority of India**. It offers a number of advantages like the seamless movement of the traffic due to automatic collection of toll, automatic scanning and data logging, and higher security as it is difficult to counterfeit.
- Recently, E-way bills were also integrated with FASTag and RFID. E-way bill is an electronic document to be carried by a person carrying a consignment of goods with a value greater than Rs. 50000 whether inter or intra state. It is mandated by the GST.



Q.82) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Kanchipuram is situated on the banks of river **Vegavathi** in the present day state of Tamil Nadu. It was home to around 1000 temples while 126 are remaining at present. Kanchipuram is also famous for its silk weaving work.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Out of the 126 temples remaining in the city 108 temples are dedicated to Shiva while the 18 temples are dedicated to Vishnu. **Kailasanathar** and the **Ekambareshwar Temple** are dedicated to Lord Shiva while the **Varadharaja Perumal Temple** is dedicated to Lord Vishnu.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Kanchipuram was the capital of the **Pallava Kingdom** from the 6th to 9th Century. It was famous for its Dravidian style of temple architecture. **Kailashnathar Temple** was built by the Pallava ruler Rajasimha I and is marked by the 16 sided shivling. **Vijayanagara ruler Krishnadevaraya** built the **Ekambareshwar temple** gopuram. The temple is uniquely marked by the presence of a 1000 pillared hallway. **Varadharaja Perumal Temple** was reconstructed by the Chola rulers. However the original evidence of the 7th century construction of the temple is not available. The temple is dedicated to Lord Vishnu and is marked by the presence of hundred pillared mandapam. The above temples along with others were added to UNESCO's tentative list of World Heritage Sites.

Q.83) Ans: C

Exp:

- The Finance Ministry recently granted 'Infrastructure' status for **exhibition and convention centres** which have been included in the latest **"Harmonised Master List of Infrastructure sub-sectors"**
- The list is notified by the **Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance** and includes various industries from the Transport, Energy, Water and Sanitation, Logistics, Communication etc. sectors.
- Inclusion in the list implies access to concessional funds, promotion of projects and continuity of construction for the specified sub-sectors. The

infrastructure tag however does not include vital tax breaks.

Q.84) Ans: D

Exp:

- As on date, there are 40 Sites from India in the UNESCO World heritage list. The 39th WHS is Ramappa temple, located in Palampet in Telangana's Warangal.
- At the 44th session of the UNESCO World Heritage Committee on at Fuzhou, China, Dholavira, the Harappan-era archaeological site located in Kutch district of Gujarat, was inscribed on the UNESCO list of world heritage sites, making it the first site of Indus Valley Civilisation in India to be included on the coveted list. It is the recent 40th WHS site.
- This year 6 sites were added to **India's tentative list of UNESCO world heritage sites**.
 - Hirebenakal Megalithic Site in Karnataka
 - Satpura Tiger Reserve in Madhya Pradesh
 - Temples of Kanchipuram
 - Ganga ghats in Varanasi
 - Bhedaghat-Lameta Ghat of Narmada Valley
 - Maratha military architecture in Maharashtra

Q.85) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Both the statements are incorrect**
- Recently, the **International Energy Agency's (IEA)** released its Net Zero Emissions (NZE) Roadmap - named **'Net Zero by 2050'**.
 - It is the World's first comprehensive energy roadmap which comes ahead of the United Nations Conference of the Parties (COP) 26 climate change convention in Glasgow, Scotland in November 2021.
 - **Net zero emissions'** refers to achieving an overall balance between greenhouse gas emissions produced and greenhouse gas emissions taken out of the atmosphere
- **Race to Zero** is the UN-backed global campaign rallying non-state actors – including companies,

cities, regions, financial and educational institutions – to take rigorous and immediate action to halve global emissions by 2030 and deliver a healthier, fairer, zero-carbon world in time. Race To Zero mobilizes actors outside of national governments to join the Climate Ambition Alliance.

Online service providers and Ways in which the earlier two can work together.

- **India** is one of the **member** countries.

Reference:

OnlyIAS May 2021 Magazine

Q.86) Ans: D

Exp:

About New Big 5 Project:

- It is an international initiative of **more than 250** of the world's **wildlife photographers**, conservationists and wildlife charities.
- It has been created by **British photographer Graeme Green**.
- Its aim is to **raise awareness** about the crisis facing the world's wildlife from threats including habitat loss, human-wildlife conflict, poaching, illegal wildlife trade and climate change.
- The Project has named the five animals for framing instead of firing at. These are the **elephant, polar bear, gorilla, tiger and lion**.
- All the New Big 5 animals are **keystone species**, essential to the balance of nature in their habitats, biodiverse ecosystems and the survival of other species, including humans.

Reference:

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/two-kaziranga-animals-in-photographers-global-big-5-rhino-not-in-list/article34584379.ece>

Q.87) Ans: C

Exp:

About Christchurch Call to Action:

- The call is named after the **New Zealand city, Christchurch** where 51 members of the Muslim community were murdered in a **live-streamed terrorist attack** in 2019.
- It was launched during the **Online Extremism Summit** in Paris, France in 2019, co-chaired by New Zealand and France.
- The Christchurch Call is a **global pledge by member governments and technology partners**. Under this, they work together to **address terrorist and violent extremist contents online**.
- The pledge is **non-binding**. It consists of three sections or commitments. The governments,

Q.88) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** **Helmand** is also known as **Hillmand or Helman** and, in ancient times, as **Hermand** and **Hethumand**. It is one of the **34 provinces of Afghanistan**, in the **south** of the country. It is the largest province by area. The province contains 13 districts.



- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** **Vorukh** is an **exclave of Tajik territory**, surrounded by Kyrgyzstan. Recently clashes have broken out between Tajikistan and Kyrgyzstan with the affairs of Vorukh.



- **Pair 3 is correct:** **Cali** is the second-largest city in **Colombia by area** and the third most populous. It is the only major Colombian city with access to the **Pacific Coast**. Recently, the Colombian Army has

tightened its control over Cali following the latest anti-government protests.



Q.89) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Putola Nach is **string puppetry** (not shadow puppetry) of **Assam**. 'Putul' is a word that describes both a **doll** and a **puppet** in Bengali while the word 'Naach' means **Dance**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The puppetry includes the **episodes of the Ramayana**, as well as scenes from the **Mahabharata**. Further, the puppeteers also add **dialogues or chants** taken from **Bhaona** (the local traditional theatre of Assam).

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The puppetry is performed in three areas with distinct characteristics. These areas are:

- **The First area – Lower Assam:** Here this puppetry form is known as **Putala-Bhoariya** and influenced by the popular folk form **Bhoariya**.
- **The second area – Majuli island (Upper Assam):** Here **small wooden puppets** are used in the style of the **Ankia Naat**. (Anika Naat is an act developed by **Sankaradeva**).
- **The third area is North Assam:** Here the puppeteers use **Bangla, Assamese and Karbi songs** in their performances. These are largely borrowed from the **mobile theatre of Assam (Bhraymaman)**.

Q.90) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** A currency swap is a transaction in which two parties exchange an equivalent amount of money with each other but in different currencies. It is an off-balance sheet transaction. It is also known as a Cross currency swap. Often the agreement consists of swapping principal and interest payments on a loan made in one currency for principal and interest payments of a loan of equal value in another currency.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The purpose of the Currency Risk Facility is manifold. This facility provides the flexibility to maintain an appropriate level of balance of payments or short-term liquidity. Swaps agreements between governments have supplementary objectives like the promotion of bilateral trade, maintaining the value of foreign exchange reserves with the central bank and ensuring financial stability. They are also used to obtain foreign currency loans at a better interest rate than could be obtained by borrowing directly in a foreign market. However, Countries are exposed to credit risk as either one or both the parties could default on interest and principal payments.

Q.91) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Velavadar Blackbuck National Park, Bhavnagar, Gujarat is a 34-sq-km park famous for Blackbucks. Flat land and a grassland ecosystem has helped in the protection of Blackbucks in this area. They move around in gendered groups – the males together, and the females and fawns in their own groups.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Bishnoi is a community found in the Western Thar Desert and northern states of India. They are known for their love for nature worship and wildlife conservation. The Bishnois consider the blackbuck to be the reincarnation of their religious Guru Bhagwan Jambheshwar also known as Jambaji. Thus, they worship them.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Blackbuck is now a rare species, surviving in small scattered herds in about 13 states of India. It is found from Punjab and Haryana in the north to Tamil Nadu in the south, and Rajasthan-Gujarat in the west to Odisha in the



east, but nowhere in vast herds. It is notably found in the Velavadar Blackbuck National Park, Bhavnagar, Gujarat. The Tal Chhapar Blackbuck Sanctuary, Churu district, Rajasthan and Point Calimere Sanctuary in Tamil Nadu is another place to find Blackbuck. It is also found on the Deccan Plateau like The sanctuary is the Rehekuri Blackbuck Sanctuary in Ahmednagar, Maharashtra is home to the Indian Black Buck.

Q.92) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is Correct:** The Notified disasters covered under SDRF are Cyclone, drought, earthquake, fire, flood, tsunami, hailstorm, landslide, avalanche, cloudburst, pest attack, frost and cold waves. It is used to meet the expenditures for providing immediate relief to the victims. It was formed in accordance with the recommendations of the 13th Finance Commission.
- **Statement 2 is Incorrect:** The Centre contributes 75% of the SDRF allocation for general category States and Union Territories and 90% for special category States and Union Territories (northeastern States, Sikkim, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir).
- **Statement 3 is Correct:** SDRF has been constituted under the Disaster Management Act, 2005. It is the primary fund available with the State governments for responses to notified disasters to meet expenditure for providing immediate relief. The State Disaster Relief Fund is to be audited by the CAG of India every year.

Q.93) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Both India and Oman are members of the Indian Ocean Rim Association. Whereas, Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) is a political and economic alliance of six Middle Eastern countries—Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, the United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Bahrain, and Oman. India is not a member of GCC.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Al Nagah is a 14-day exercise between both the armies exchanging expertise and experience in tactics, weapon handling and firing. The exercise is aimed to enhance interoperability in counterterrorist

operations in semi-urban mountainous terrain. Other exercises between India and Oman are an Air Force exercise called Eastern Bridge and a Naval Exercise called Naseem Al Bahr.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Port of Duqm is strategically located situated on the southeastern seaboard of Oman, overlooking Arabian Sea and Indian Ocean providing access to East Africa and also to the red sea via the Gulf of Aden. It is a deep-sea port (18 m) with a dry dock facility and comes under the Special Economic Zone at Duqm (SEZD). Oman has allowed India, including its navy, access to its Duqm port, about 550 km south of the capital Muscat. The Port of Duqm SEZ is earmarked to be the Indian Ocean's largest deep-sea port.

Q.94) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Mars Orbiter Mission/ Mangalyaan is a space probe orbiting Mars by the Indian Space Research Organisation. It is India's first interplanetary mission and it made it the fourth space agency to achieve Mars orbit, after Roscosmos, NASA, and the European Space Agency. It made India the first Asian nation to reach Martian orbit and the first nation in the world to do so on its maiden attempt.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Tianwen-1 is an interplanetary mission by the China National Space Administration to send a robotic spacecraft to Mars. Recently, it landed on Mars carrying to conduct scientific investigations into the planet's soil, geological structure, environment, atmosphere and water. With this achievement, China became the only second country after the US to send a rover to the surface of the Red Planet. NASA's Viking in 1976 made history as the first probe to land safely on Mars.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** OSIRIS-REx is NASA's first mission to visit a near-Earth asteroid, survey its surface and collect a sample from it. The spacecraft departed from asteroid Bennu, and started its two-year long journey back to Earth. As per NASA, this mission is expected to bring the largest amount of extraterrestrial material in the form of surface and dust particles back to the Earth, since the Apollo Era.



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- The European Space Agency tried to land on Mars in 2003, when its Beagle 2 probe crashed. Its ExoMars Schiaparelli spacecraft crashed in 2016 after software incorrectly estimated its altitude during an attempted landing.
- The Soviet Union made several attempts in the 1970s and its Mars 3 probe reached the surface in 1971 but only transmitted back to Earth for less than a minute before going silent.

Certification” (LAC) to harness these potential areas. Recently, the Government of India has certified 14,491 ha of area under Car Nicobar and Nancowry group of islands in UT of A&N Islands as the first large contiguous territory to be conferred with organic certification under the ‘Large Area Certification’ (LAC) scheme of the PGS-India (Participatory Guarantee System) certification programme.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1714281>

Q.95) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Organic farming has been identified as a viable option promising safe and chemical residue-free food and long-term sustainability of food production systems. India now has more than 30 lakh hectares registered under organic certification. As per the international survey report (2021), India ranks at 5th place in terms of area and is at the top in terms of total number of producers (base year 2019).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** As per the established norm of organic production systems, the areas having chemical input usage history are required to undergo a transition period of minimum 2-3 years to qualify as organic. During this period, farmers need to adopt standard organic agriculture practices and keep their farms under the certification process. On successful completion, such farms can be certified as organic after 2-3 years. The certification process also requires elaborate documentation and time to time verification by the certification authorities. Hence, the period of one decade is not needed.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Despite deep inroads of modern agricultural practices, still, there are large contiguous areas in hills, tribal districts, desert and rainfed areas in India that continue to remain free from chemical input usage. The **Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare** under its flagship scheme of **Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojna (PKVY)** has launched a unique quick certification programme “Large Area

Q.96) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The recent **AISHE (All India Survey of Higher Education)** report is the 10th in the series annually released by the Department of Higher Education. The continuous rise in the enrolment, number of institutions, gender parity as highlighted by the report is a part of the shift towards improving access, equity and quality in light of National Education Policy 2020. The report takes into consideration the Universities, colleges, and the stand-alone institutions of the country.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Gender Parity Index (GPI)** in Higher Education in 2019-20 as per the report is at 1.01 against 1.00 in 2018-19 indicating an improvement in the relative access to higher education for females of the eligible age group compared to males. The value of 1 indicates equality among the males and the females while the value greater than 1 shows the favor towards females as compared to males or the disparity in favor of females.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1725914>

Q.97) Ans: D

Exp:



- **Article 39** of the Constitution of India forms a part of the Directive Principles of State Policy under Part IV of the Constitution. As per Article 39(e), it is the responsibility of the State to ensure that the health and strength of workers, men and women, and the tender age of children are not abused and that citizens are not forced by economic necessity to enter a vocation unsuited to their age or strength. Hence, it deals with the provisions regarding child labor.
- As per the **Convention 182 of the ILO**, there is the need to adopt new instruments for the prohibition and elimination of the worst forms of child labor as the main priority for national and international action, including international cooperation and assistance. The convention 138 of the ILO deals with the adoption of certain proposals with regard to minimum age for admission to employment.
- In 1979, Government formed the committee called **Gurupadswamy Committee** to study the issue of child labour and to suggest measures to tackle it. The Committee observed that as long as poverty continued, it would be difficult to totally eliminate child labour.
- The **86th Constitutional Amendment, 2002** introduced the following changes in the Constitution:
 - **Article 21A** was added that states that the State shall provide free and compulsory education to all children of the age of six to fourteen years in such manner as the State may, by law, determine.
 - **Changed Article 45** to include that the State shall endeavor to provide early childhood care and education for all children until they complete the age of six years.
 - **Article 51A (k)** was added to the fundamental duties. It states that a person who is a parent or guardian should provide opportunities for education to his child or ward between the age of six and fourteen years.
- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The **Chimeric Antigen Receptor T-cell (CAR-T)** therapy has emerged as a breakthrough in cancer treatment. Clinical trials conducted globally have shown promising results in end stage patients, especially in patients suffering from Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia. This is a “first in India” gene therapy in an early phase pilot clinical trial created with the efforts of IIT Bombay and Tata Memorial Hospital, Mumbai. The central government’s **National Biopharma Mission-BIRAC** has approved 19.15 Cr crore to the team for conducting a first-in-human phase-1/2 clinical trial of the CAR-T cells. Though this technology has a remarkable therapeutic potential for cancer patients, at present this technology is not available in India. Each patient’s CAR-T cell therapy costs 3-4 crore (INR). The challenge therefore is to develop this technology in a cost-effective manner and make it available for the patients. The manufacturing complexity is a major reason for the therapy cost.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Gene therapy** refers to the replacement of faulty genes, or the addition of new genes as a means to cure disease or improve the ability to fight disease. **Genome editing** is one aspect of gene therapy. **CRISPR/Cas9**, is based on RNA-guided targeting techniques for generating molecular tools for cutting the DNA of genomes in specific places to allow targeted alterations in the DNA sequence. It is much simpler, faster, and cheaper technology.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **TALENs** or transcription activator-like effector nucleases, **ZFNs**, and Zinc-finger nucleases are the techniques in the cutting of the DNA that preceded the development of CRISPR/Cas9. **Zinc fingers** are segments of protein that have evolved to recognize and bind to specific DNA sequences. **TALENs** are composed of a DNA-binding protein that recognizes particular DNA sequences fused to a nucleus effector domain to achieve the cut.

Source:

<https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1725254>

<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK447276/>

Hence, all the above provisions deal with child labour.

Q.98) Ans: A

Exp:

Q.99) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Ram Prasad Bismil** was amongst the most notable Indian revolutionaries who fought against British colonialism. He wrote powerful patriotic poems in Urdu and Hindi under the pen name of Bismil. The HRA was founded in October 1924 in Kanpur by Ramprasad Bismil, Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee and Sachin Sanyal, with an aim to organise an armed revolution to overthrow the colonial government and establish in its place the Federal Republic of United States of India whose basic principle would be adult franchise. He participated in the Mainpuri conspiracy of 1918, and the Kakori conspiracy of 1925 with Ashfaq Ullah Khan and Roshan Singh. He wrote 'Mera Rang De BasantiChola' and 'Sarfaroshi Ki Tamanna' which became the anthem for freedom fighters.
- **Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay** Born in Naihati, Bengal on June 27, 1838. He was a significant figure in India's struggle for independence. He published his first fiction work, Rajmohan's Wife in English and it is regarded as the first Indian novel to be written in English. He wrote the first Bengali novel in 1865, Durgeshnandini, which was a historical romance work. His first major publication came to be Kapalkundala which is considered to be one of the finest works of Indian literature. Bankim started publishing a monthly literary magazine Bangadarshan in April 1872. Bishabriksha (The Poison Tree, 1873) was the first novel of Bankim that appeared serially in Bangadarshan. This work tackled the issue of widow remarriage and again showed women as capable of living on their own. The most noteworthy contribution Bankim made to the nationalistic imagination was the political novel **Anandamath** which was based on the 'sannyasi rebellion' of the late 18th century. It was in Anandamath that Bankim wrote the poem '**Vande Mataram**'.
- **Jyotirao Govindrao Phule** was an Indian writer, social activist, thinker and anti-caste social reformer from Maharashtra. He and his wife, **Savitribai Phule**, were pioneers of women's education in India. Phule started the first school for girls in 1848 in Pune. He, along with his followers, formed the **Satyashodhak**

Samaj (Society of Truth Seekers) in 1873 to attain equal rights for people from exploited castes. Savitribai was a renowned poet too and she published two poetic collections, **Kavya Phule** and **Bhavan Kashi Subodh Ratnakar**.

- **Surendra Nath Banerjee** was one of the earliest Indian political leaders during the British Raj. He founded the **Indian National Association**, one of the earliest Indian political organizations. The Nation in the Making was written by Surendra Nath Banerjee.

Source:

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaselframePage.aspx?PRID=1726382> ;

<https://www.indiatoday.in/fyi/story/remembering-bankim-chandra-chattopadhyay-the-man-who-gave-us-vande-mataram-1270907-2018-06-27>

<https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/savitribai-phule-education-feminism-women-empowerment-7131478/>

Q.100) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The **Chimeric Antigen Receptor T-cell (CAR-T)** therapy has emerged as a breakthrough in cancer treatment. Clinical trials conducted globally have shown promising results in end stage patients, especially in patients suffering from Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia. This is a "first in India" gene therapy in an early phase pilot clinical trial created with the efforts of IIT Bombay and Tata Memorial Hospital, Mumbai. The central government's **National Biopharma Mission-BIRAC** has approved 19.15 Cr crore to the team for conducting a first-in-human phase-1/2 clinical trial of the CAR-T cells. Though this technology has a remarkable therapeutic potential for cancer patients, at present this technology is not available in India. Each patient's CAR-T cell therapy costs 3-4 crore (INR). The challenge therefore is to develop this technology in a cost-effective manner and make it available for the patients. The manufacturing complexity is a major reason for the therapy cost.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** **Gene therapy** refers to the replacement of faulty genes, or the addition



of new genes as a means to cure disease or improve the ability to fight disease. **Genome editing** is one aspect of gene therapy. **CRISPR/Cas9**, is based on RNA-guided targeting techniques for generating molecular tools for cutting the DNA of genomes in specific places to allow targeted alterations in the DNA sequence. It is much simpler, faster, and cheaper technology.

- **Statement 3 is correct: TALENS** or transcription activator-like effector nucleases, **ZFNs**, and Zinc-finger nucleases are the techniques in the cutting of the DNA that preceded the development of CRISPR/Cas9. **Zinc fingers** are segments of protein that have evolved to recognize and bind to specific DNA sequences. **TALENs** are composed of a DNA-binding protein that recognizes particular DNA sequences fused to a nucleus effector domain to achieve the cut.

Source:

<https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1725254>

<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK447276/>